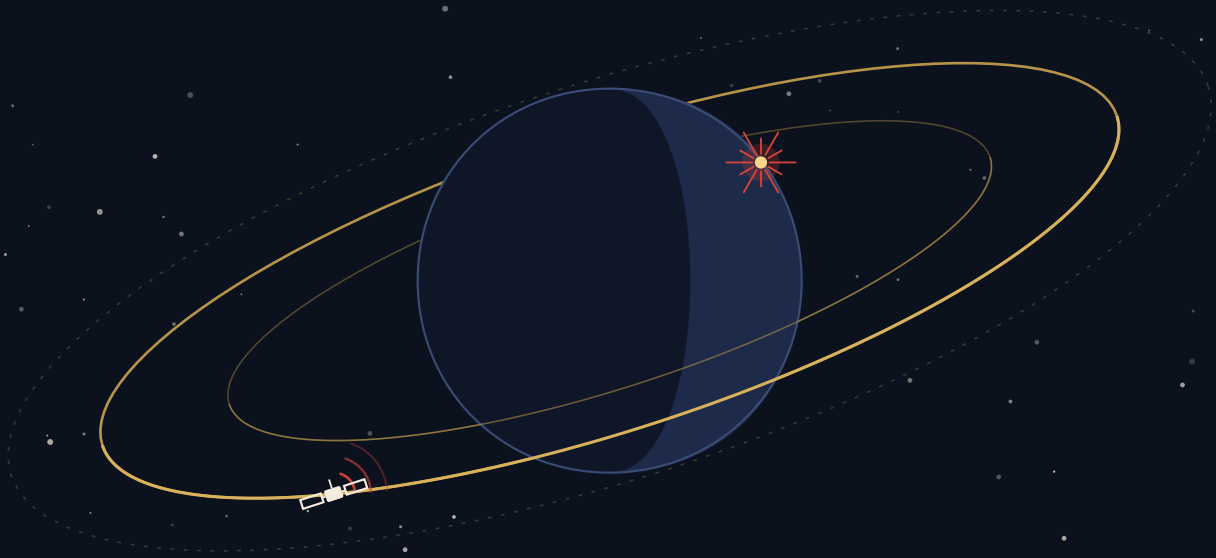


A DOCTORAL THESIS

Orbital Eschatology

Wergild, Voice, and the Diurnal Commons in Philip K. Dick's Dr. Bloodmoney, or How We Got Along After the Bomb

23 OCTOBER 2026 · IN EARTH'S DIURNAL COURSE

“It is not lawful for to put them into the treasury, because it is the price of blood.”

MATTHEW 27:6, AUTHORIZED VERSION

Rolled round in earth’s diurnal course,
With rocks, and stones, and trees.

WILLIAM WORDSWORTH, “A SLUMBER DID MY SPIRIT SEAL” (1800)

Contents

Abstract 5

Note on Texts, Citation, and Method 7

INTRODUCTION
The Hinge and the Ledger 9

CHAPTER ONE
Blood Money: The Wergild Cosmos 15

CHAPTER TWO
The Paranoid Demiurge: Bluthgeld and the Armed Private World 23

CHAPTER THREE
The Exception and the Sovereign: Hoppy Harrington and Ventriloquial Power 29

CHAPTER FOUR
The Voice in the Sky: Dangerfield and the Constitution of a Common World 37

CHAPTER FIVE
The Crypt and the Bardo: Bill Keller and the Metempsychotic Settlement 45

CHAPTER SIX
The Diurnal Commons: Bricolage, Homeostasis, and the Ethics of Getting Along 53

CHAPTER SEVEN
Orbital Eschatology: The Thesis Stated 63

CONCLUSION
How We Get Along 69

Works Cited 71

Keywords 78

FIGURES AND TABLES

TABLE 1 The conjuncture of *Dr. Bloodmoney*, 1957–1965 11

FIGURE 1 The Wergild Square 21

TABLE 2 Six settlements of the post-catastrophe novel 57

TABLE 3 The cast on the Wheel of Becoming 59

Abstract

This dissertation argues that Philip K. Dick's *Dr. Bloodmoney, or How We Got Along After the Bomb* (written 1963; published 1965) is neither a consolatory post-apocalyptic pastoral nor reducible to the character system that Fredric Jameson's celebrated Greimasian reading anatomized, but a speculative treatise on compensation: an inquiry into how a world pays, or fails to pay, for an injury it cannot price. The commercial title, imposed by Ace Books in the slipstream of Kubrick's *Dr. Strangelove*, names more than it intended. *Blutgeld* is wergild, the archaic tariff that converts homicide into debt. Read through Anaximander's fragment on cosmic restitution, Nietzsche's derivation of guilt (*Schuld*) from debt (*Schulden*), and Marx's citation of Augier on the congenital bloodstain of money, the title discloses a *wergild cosmos* in which catastrophe incurs obligations payable in guilt, in flesh, and in sovereignty.

The novel distributes these settlements across its character system. Bruno Bluthgeld's paranoia internalizes an infinite debt (Freud's Schreber, Binswanger's *idios kosmos*, Anders's Promethean gap). Hoppy Harrington's ressentiment converts congenital injury into a claim upon sovereignty (Freud's "Exceptions," Adler, Canetti, Hobbes, Schmitt). Walt Dangerfield's orbital broadcast institutes an economy of the unreturnable gift (the Heraclitean common *logos*, Arendt, Sartre, Benjamin, McLuhan). Bill Keller, the encrypted twin who hears the dead, executes a *metempsychotic settlement* that closes the ledger not by payment but by re-tenancy (Abraham and Torok, the *Bardo Thödol*, the Myth of Er).

Against this ground the thesis advances three original concepts. *Orbital eschatology* designates the novel's conversion of the punctual apocalypse into a recurrent passage overhead: the end does not arrive, it circles, as both Dangerfield's satellite and the novel's working title, *In Earth's Diurnal Course*, drawn from Wordsworth's Lucy poem, attest. *Phonic justice* designates the just distribution of the capacity to speak and to be heard among the living, the dead, animals, and machines; it is opposed to *ventriloquial sovereignty*, the capture of a common voice by an injured exception who speaks as others. The *diurnal commons* designates the polity these concepts imply: constituted by co-audition rather than by representation, decision, or contract, and sustained by bricolage, homeostatic feedback, and the daily repetition of listening.

Methodologically, the study proposes a revised semiotic square (the Wergild Square), a cryptonymic exegesis of Dick's onomastics, a heuristic mapping of the cast onto the Buddhist Wheel of Becoming, and a media-archaeological reconstruction of the novel's conjuncture of 1962–63: Starfish Prime, Telstar, the Cuban crisis,

thalidomide, and the Partial Test Ban Treaty. Comparative readings situate the novel against Miller, Shute, Frank, Stewart, Vonnegut, Kubrick, Lem, Wyndham, Sturgeon, Le Guin, Hoban, Butler, McCarthy, and Mandel, and trace its afterlife within Dick's oeuvre from Dangerfield to VALIS. The dissertation concludes that *Dr. Bloodmoney* returns the most rigorous answer in its genre to Herman Kahn's question whether the survivors of thermonuclear war would envy the dead: they would not, provided the dead are heard rather than impersonated.

Note on Texts, Citation, and Method

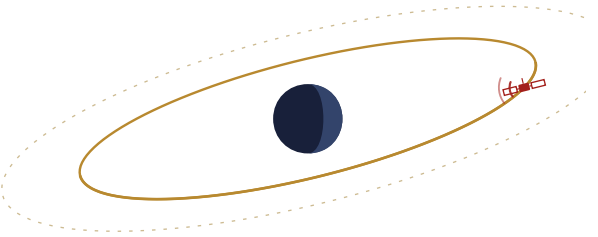
References to *Dr. Bloodmoney* cite chapters by roman numeral (I–XVI), since pagination varies across the Ace (1965), Gregg Press (1977), Dell (1980), Bluejay (1985), Vintage (2002), and Library of America (2008) printings. Dick's 1980 afterword is cited from the Dell edition, and the working titles from Jonathan Lethem's "Notes on the Text" in the Library of America volume (Lethem 2008). In deference to a work still in copyright, quotation from the novel is held to a minimum and its language is paraphrased. Texts in the public domain (Anaximander, Heraclitus, the Authorized Version, Shakespeare, Hobbes, Berkeley, Wordsworth, Marx, Nietzsche in Thomas Common's translation) are quoted where exact wording carries the argument.

Parenthetical citations give author and the date of original publication; the Works Cited supplies full details. Renderings from French, German, Greek, Italian, and Latin are paraphrases unless marked as quotation. Dick's essays are cited from *The Shifting Realities of Philip K. Dick* (1995), his late speculations from the *Exegesis* (2011).

Three protocols require advance notice. *Cryptonymic* readings of names are offered as authorized speculation: Dick's onomastic play is documented (Bluthgeld, Lufteufel, Horselover Fat), which licenses attention to the semantic charge of names without ascribing every resonance to authorial design. The mapping of the cast onto the six realms of the Buddhist Wheel of Becoming is a *heuristic* instrument, not a claim of influence. *Psychobiographical* material concerning Dick's twin sister is used transferentially, as a pressure exerted on the text's figures, never as their cause.

INTRODUCTION

0



The Hinge and the Ledger

> *The catastrophe is encountered as already survived.*

I Problem and Argument

The bomb in *Dr. Bloodmoney* is a hinge, not a terminus. Herman Kahn's *On Thermonuclear War* (1960) had asked whether the survivors of a general nuclear exchange would envy the dead, and answered, with the actuarial serenity Kubrick would soon lampoon, that they would not. Dick's subtitle restates the question in the grammar of the survivors themselves: *How We Got Along After the Bomb*. Every term is load-bearing. The past tense presumes a vantage after the after; the first-person plural presumes a community still capable of saying "we"; the colloquial verb holds three senses in suspension (to manage materially, to coexist without violence, to grow old); and the preposition announces a book composed entirely of afterlives, of persons, commodities, voices, and the dead.

The novel makes the hinge visible through a deliberate disorder of sequence. Three chapters render a working day in Berkeley in 1981. The fourth leaps seven years to West Marin, where survivors gather in the Foresters' Hall to hear an orbiting astronaut read Somerset Maugham. Only in the fifth does the strike arrive, refracted through the astigmatic perceptions of a physicist who mistakes real cracks in masonry for distortions of his own sight, a salesman sheltering in a basement, an astronaut watching fires bloom beneath his capsule, and Bonny Keller, who watches San Francisco's destruction from Marin and then walks away from her shattered windows (IV–V). Who launched the strike the novel never establishes: Dangerfield's ground contact reports an attack before falling silent, the psychiatrist reasons that it must be an accident, and the physicist believes his own mind caused it, all against the background of a war with China and the Soviet Union already being fought in Cuba (I, V–VI). The catastrophe is encountered as already survived. Before it is narrated it has been outlived, and the text's first approach to it is prolepsis: a structural decision that converts the event of

the end into something the narrative circles. This dissertation names that conversion *orbital eschatology*.

The argument proceeds from a philological wager. The title under which the book was sold was not its author's. Dick's working titles were *In Earth's Diurnal Course* and *A Terran Odyssey*; the commercial title, proposed by Donald A. Wollheim at Ace, borrowed its syntax from Kubrick's *Dr. Strangelove, or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Bomb* (1964) (Lethem 2008). Yet the imposed title names, with a precision its marketer cannot have intended, the novel's deepest preoccupation. *Blutgeld* is wergild, the tariff by which archaic law converted homicide into debt and vendetta into payment. It is also the *pretium sanguinis* of Matthew's gospel, the thirty pieces the chief priests could not return to the treasury, "because it is the price of blood" (Matt. 27:6), and with which they bought a potter's field to bury strangers. In each of its plots the novel asks what can be paid for a death, by whom, and in what currency. It discovers that the currencies of compensation (guilt, flesh, sovereignty, tobacco) are counterfeit, and that only one medium circulates without debt: the voice freely given and freely heard.

The thesis is developed in five propositions, stated formally in Chapter Seven. First, the bomb is a hinge and the novel a settlement: its subject is not destruction but the reckoning destruction opens. Second, "blood money" names the false currency of catastrophe, an economy of compensation in which the paranoid debtor (Bruno Bluthgeld) and the ressentimental creditor (Hoppy Harrington) are mortally bound. Third, voice is the true currency of the commons, and the novel's political ideal is *phonic justice*, the equitable distribution of the capacity to speak and to be heard. Fourth, justice after catastrophe is *metempsychotic* rather than retributive: the ledger closes when an injured form is re-inhabited by a consciousness free of ressentiment. Fifth, the eschaton orbits: the end is not an event but a recurrence, heard each evening as a voice passing overhead.

II Composition and Conjuncture

Dick wrote the novel in 1963 at Point Reyes Station, the West Marin village where he had lived since 1958 with his third wife, Anne, and whose topography, institutions, and gossip he transposes with documentary fidelity. The year belongs to the period Darko Suvin's 1975 survey identifies as Dick's first maturity: *The Man in the High Castle* had won the Hugo in 1963, *Martian Time-Slip* and *The Three Stigmata of Palmer Eldritch* were written in the eighteen months surrounding *Dr. Bloodmoney*, and the novel itself would be nominated for the Nebula in 1965. The same season brought Dick's vision of a vast and malign face in the sky over Marin, later identified as the germ of Palmer Eldritch, and his entry with Anne into the Episcopal Church (Sutin 1989). The book is thus suspended between the ensemble realism Dick had learned in his unpublished mainstream novels and the theological turn that would govern his last decade.

The conjuncture is overdetermined to a degree that reading must reconstruct, because the novel's fictional chronology encrypts it. Table 1 gathers the events that bear directly on the argument.

TABLE 1

The conjuncture of Dr. Bloodmoney, *1957–1965*

DATE	EVENT	BEARING ON THE NOVEL
Oct 1957	Thalidomide marketed in West Germany as Contergan; Sputnik 1 launched	Hoppy's congenital injury; the first earth-born object in orbit
1958	Binswanger's case studies reach English readers in *Existence* (May, Angel, Ellenberger)	Dick's source for *idios* and *koinos kosmos*
1959–60	Miller's *A Canticle for Leibowitz*, Frank's *Alas, Babylon*, Roshwald's *Level 7*; Kahn's *On Thermonuclear War*	The genre's settlements; the survivors' question
1961	Contergan withdrawn (November); Anders–Eatherly correspondence published	Iatrogenic injury and its compensation; guilt as sanity
9 Jul 1962	Starfish Prime detonated 400 km above Johnston Island	Model for the novel's miscarried high-altitude test of 1972
10 Jul 1962	Telstar, first active communications satellite, launched	Model for Dangerfield's broadcasting capsule
1962	Carson's *Silent Spring*; Lévi-Strauss's *La Pensée sauvage*; McLuhan's *The Gutenberg Galaxy*	Invisible contamination; bricolage; acoustic space
Oct 1962	Cuban Missile Crisis	The novel's "police action" in Cuba
Feb 1963	Telstar fails after radiation damage from the high-altitude tests	The vulnerability of the orbital commons
1963	Arendt's *Eichmann in Jerusalem*; Vonnegut's *Cat's Cradle*; Dick writes the novel	Two pathologies of responsibility; the scientist as fabulist
Aug 1963	Partial Test Ban Treaty signed	End of atmospheric testing
Jan 1964	*Dr. Strangelove* released	The commercial title
1964	McLuhan's *Understanding Media*; Dick begins *Deus Irae*	Radio as tribal drum; Dick's rewriting of his phocomelus
1965	Ace publishes *Dr. Bloodmoney*; Nebula nomination	Reception

Three features of this conjuncture govern what follows. First, the miscarried test that in the novel's history poisoned the atmosphere in 1972 has a precise referent in Starfish Prime, whose artificial radiation belt degraded satellites in low orbit; Telstar, launched the next day, was crippled by that radiation within months. The novel's two orbital figures, the catastrophic test and the broadcasting capsule, are born a day apart in the historical record: the bomb and the voice in the sky are twins. Second, when a coworker assumes that Hoppy is a casualty of the 1972 test, Hoppy corrects him: his

limblessness is the work of thalidomide (II). The distinction between pharmacological and nuclear injury, between a commodity and a weapon, is the hinge of the novel's theory of compensation, because it determines who owes whom. Third, the novel's alternate 1981 includes a "police action" in Cuba and, in a characteristic Dickian joke, an FBI under Richard Nixon that deplores Bluthgeld's anti-communist paranoia as excessive (I). The paranoid physicist is calibrated against the most paranoid public figure in Dick's imaginary and found worse.

III State of the Field

Criticism of the novel has been dense rather than voluminous, and it was shaped decisively by the special Dick issue of *Science Fiction Studies* (no. 5, March 1975), which printed Suvin's periodizing survey, Stanisław Lem's polemic hailing Dick as a visionary among charlatans, and Fredric Jameson's "After Armageddon: Character Systems in *Dr. Bloodmoney*" (Jameson 1975). Jameson's essay remains indispensable. Deploying the Greimasian semiotic rectangle to read the cast as a system of positions rather than a gallery of persons, it treats the post-catastrophe world as a space in which an economy of small business, handicraft, and repair (the economy of the television salesman and the repairman) can be imagined again, and it finds in the ending, where a tobacconist, a salesman, and a radio engineer plan an automated cigarette works in Berkeley, the Utopian resolution of contradictions the pre-war world could not resolve (XVI).

Kim Stanley Robinson's monograph, written as a dissertation under Jameson's direction, extended that reading toward the novel's realist ensemble (Robinson 1984a). Patricia Warrick (1987), Douglas Mackey (1988), Christopher Palmer (2003), and Umberto Rossi (2011) situate the novel within Dick's ontological uncertainty. Laurence Rickels reads the oeuvre through mourning, psychosis, and media (Rickels 2010). Rossi's essay on acousmatic presences identifies Dangerfield as a founding instance of the disc jockey as unseen voice, a lineage this study extends into political theory (Rossi 2009).

Three lacunae structure the present intervention. No reading has taken the commercial title seriously as a hermeneutic key, and so none has integrated the novel's economic, juridical, and theological registers of compensation. No reading has held the novel's three acoustic figures (the satellite voice, the mimic, the twin who hears the dead) together as a single system whose stake is the distribution of voice. And although the novel places a congenitally disabled man at the center of its political drama, disability studies has not engaged it, nor has the fact of Dick's dead twin been brought to bear on the novel's living, encrypted twin with the rigor the psychoanalytic theory of the crypt affords.

IV Method

The study deploys four instruments under a single comparative discipline. The first is the semiotic rectangle, revised. Where Jameson's square maps the cast onto contradictions of production, the Wergild Square of Chapter One maps it onto contradictions of obligation, with debt and gift as contraries. The device has a Dickian afterlife: Robinson's *Red Mars* (1992) places a character before a Greimas rectangle, so the instrument migrated from criticism of Dick into the science fiction his critics went on to write.

The second is cryptonymy, after Nicolas Abraham and Maria Torok's analysis of words that hide the unmourned inside the ego (Abraham and Torok 1976; Derrida 1976). The novel's names behave like crypts. *Bluthgeld* encrypts *Blutgeld*; his alias, Tree, encrypts the closing line of the Wordsworth poem that furnished the working title; *Stockstill* names the analyst's abstention; *Keller* names both a cellar and the most famous deafblind woman of the century; the capsule that cannot reach Mars or return is the *Dutchman IV*, the Flying Dutchman condemned to sail until Judgment. Two further names belong to the same order: a gill is a quarter-pint measure of spirits, the unit in which Andrew Gill's brandy would be poured, and Harrington was the surname of the seventeenth-century republican who argued that political power follows the balance of property, as Hoppy's follows his monopoly of repair (Harrington 1656).

The third is a heuristic drawn from the *Bardo Thödol* in W. Y. Evans-Wentz's edition, which Dick would later use as the architecture of *Ubik* (1969). Its warrant lies in the novel itself: in 1981 Hoppy falls into a trance and claims to see beyond the grave, and he describes Stuart McConchie eating a raw rat; in the shelter after the strike Stuart does exactly that, and grasps that Hoppy had seen not the afterlife but the future (III, VI). The novel equates the post-war world with the realm beyond death, and licenses a reading of West Marin as a collective *bardo*, an intermediate state between a world's death and its rebirth.

The fourth is media archaeology in the lineage of Friedrich Kittler, Jeffrey Sconce, Michel Chion, and Michel Serres: the reconstruction of the novel's technical a priori (television, transistor radio, tape, satellite relay, servo-mechanical extensors) as the condition of its metaphysics. The comparative discipline that binds these instruments is Walter Benjamin's constellation. Works are juxtaposed not to establish influence, except where documented, but so that each illuminates a latent structure in the other.

V Plan of the Dissertation

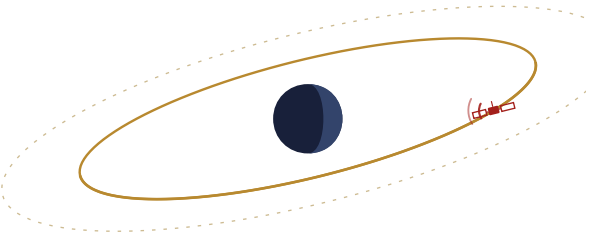
Chapter One reconstructs the wergild cosmos from Anaximander to Bataille, examines the novel's cigarette economy against the historical record of cigarette currencies after 1945, and constructs the Wergild Square. Chapter Two reads Bluthgeld as a paranoid demiurge: Freud's Schreber and Lacan's foreclosure, Binswanger's private world, Anders's Promethean gap, Arendt's Eichmann as his antithesis, and comparisons with

Vonnegut, Kubrick, Lem, and Le Guin. Chapter Three reads Hoppy as the Exception who would be sovereign: Freud's reading of Richard III, Adler, Nietzsche, Scheler, Canetti, Hobbes, Schmitt, Girard, and a disability-theoretical critique.

Chapter Four reads Dangerfield's broadcast as the constitution of a common world: Heraclitus, Arendt, Sartre, McLuhan, Benjamin, Spinoza through Maugham, Telstar, and Dick's later voices in the sky. Chapter Five reads Bill Keller through the crypt, the *bardo*, and metempsychosis, from Homer's Nekyia and Pythagoras to Kittler and Serres. Chapter Six reconstructs the ethics of getting along through bricolage, cybernetics, Camus, Adorno, Rancière, and a comparative typology of post-apocalyptic fiction. Chapter Seven states the synthetic thesis of orbital eschatology, traces its genealogy in Dick's oeuvre, and tests its pertinence to the age of synthetic voice.

CHAPTER ONE

1



Blood Money

The Wergild Cosmos

> *The money of the survivors is fire domesticated.*

1.1 The Title as Ledger

The commercial title is the first event in the novel's reception and the first datum of its interpretation. A publisher's decision to rename the book after a film it had not seen inscribed the commodity form on the cover: the market renamed the work, and the name it chose was a name for payment. The resulting paratext is a diptych. *In Earth's Diurnal Course* names cosmic recurrence, a rotation indifferent to human accounting; *Dr. Bloodmoney* names a juridico-economic reckoning; and the second working title, *A Terran Odyssey*, names a homecoming that, as Chapter Five shows, passes through the land of the dead. The novel lives in the tension between recurrence and reckoning, and its achievement is to make the first absorb the second.

Kubrick haunts the paratext from both sides. The publisher took the title from *Dr. Strangelove*, and Dick's own second working title anticipated by five years the title of *2001: A Space Odyssey* (1968), a film that also ends in a rebirth beyond the human. The two Kubrick titles bracket the novel's two concerns: the comedy of the strategists who make the end, and the odyssey of a consciousness that passes through it.

Wergild (Old English *wer*, man, and *gield*, payment) was the institution by which Germanic law priced a death in order to interrupt the feud it would otherwise provoke. The *Lex Salica* set the wergild of a free Frank at two hundred solidi and graded other lives above and below that figure, so the tariff was also a social ontology: it declared what a person was worth. The English phrase "blood money" preserves a second, darker sense, the payment made not to the kin of the slain but to the killer or the informer. Both senses are enacted in the novel. In 1981 Bonny Keller, who referred Bluthgeld to his psychiatrist, broods on what she owes him (II). In 1988 the West Marin council,

learning that Hoppy has killed the physicist, votes to reward him with Andrew Gill's tobacco and brandy and a monument, and Hoppy scorns the payment as beneath his due (XIV). Dr. Bloodmoney's death is literally paid for, and the payee finds the price insulting.

1.2 Anaximander and the Ordinance of Time

The oldest surviving sentence of Western philosophy is a sentence about compensation. Anaximander (DK 12 B1) holds that things perish into that from which they came to be, "according to necessity," for they pay *dikē* and *tisis*, penalty and retribution, to one another for their *adikia*, their injustice, according to the assessment of time. Nietzsche read the fragment as the first pessimism, in which coming-to-be is itself a guilt expiated by passing away (Nietzsche 1873). Heidegger rendered *dikē* as jointure and *adikia* as disjointure, and read being as the "while" of what lingers (Heidegger 1946). Derrida, reading Heidegger's essay beside Hamlet's complaint that the time is out of joint, made the fragment the charter of his hauntology (Derrida 1993).

The novel radicalizes the fragment in two directions. The injustice it narrates is not the ontological injustice of finite being but a technologically manufactured one, so the question of the assessor (who reckons, and by what ordinance) becomes political rather than cosmic. And the novel's "while" is literal: seven years, the interval of a covenant, a famine, or a Jacob's service. The survivors of West Marin inhabit a disjointure. Their "getting along" is a Heideggerian lingering, the provisional dwelling of beings who know the reckoning has not been made and cannot be.

1.3 *Schuld* and *Schulden*: The Second Essay of the *Genealogy*

Nietzsche's second essay derives the moral concept of guilt (*Schuld*) from the material concept of debts (*Schulden*), and the oldest social relation from that of creditor and debtor (Nietzsche 1887, II.4–8). Archaic law granted the creditor a right over the debtor's body; the Twelve Tables permitted creditors to cut shares of a defaulter's flesh without fraud if they cut more or less. Compensation took the form of a license to make suffer, and the creditor's pleasure in cruelty was the true coin of repayment. The essay's culminating paradox is theological: Christianity's stroke of genius was a creditor who sacrifices himself for the debtor, rendering the debt infinite and therefore unpayable (II.21).

The best-known literary form of that archaic right is Shylock's bond in *The Merchant of Venice*: a pound of flesh as forfeit for an unpaid loan. It has to be named, because the type has a history. Through Shylock the creditor who demands flesh was fixed as an antisemitic caricature of the Jewish moneylender, and a reading of a novel sold as *Dr. Bloodmoney* must keep that history in view rather than reproduce it. Dick assigns the creditor's role to no ethnic type: his creditor is a disabled technician and

his debtor a physicist with a German name. The novel's version of the oldest relation runs outside the antisemitic economy of the figure while keeping its logic of flesh as payment.

The novel distributes this genealogy between its two antagonists. Bluthgeld is bad conscience incarnate. He experiences himself as the cause of a world's destruction, a guilt so total that it can be neither paid nor forgiven, and it is therefore compelled to recur: in 1988, unsettled by the reappearance of a man he last saw on the day of the strike, he restarts the war in his mind, and he proclaims the demolition of existence to be sanctioned by God (XII). His theology is the *Genealogy*'s last stage inverted: the debtor appoints himself the creditor's instrument. Hoppy is the creditor. Injured at birth and humiliated by charity, he holds the world in his debt, and the compensation he exacts is the one Nietzsche describes, the pleasure of making others suffer. The novel stages the oldest relation as a murder: the creditor kills the debtor from miles away, flinging him into the air and letting him fall (XIII).

Nietzsche supplies a second key in the chapter of *Zarathustra* on the pitying, which reads in Thomas Common's translation: "Great obligations do not make grateful, but revengeful; and when a small kindness is not forgotten, it becometh a gnawing worm." Jim Fergesson, the shopkeeper whose principled hiring brought Hoppy into his store, is cut in two when the store is hit (V). Seven years later the seven-year-old Edie Keller bids Hoppy lean close, and he hears Fergesson's voice inside his head and screams (X). The dead benefactor speaks through the encrypted twin. The unforgotten kindness returns as the voice of the dead, and the twin who carries it will, in a later experiment, become a worm (XIII).

1.4 The Congenital Bloodstain: Marx, Augier, and the Money Form

The locus classicus of blood money in political economy is the penultimate chapter of the first volume of *Capital*, in the 1887 English translation: "If money, according to Augier, 'comes into the world with a congenital blood-stain on one cheek,' capital comes dripping from head to foot, from every pore, with blood and dirt" (Marx 1867, ch. 31). The adjective deserves weight. Money is born marked, and the novel's emblem of the commodity order is a man born marked by a commodity: thalidomide, marketed for profit as a sedative and morning-sickness remedy, inscribed the congenital bloodstain of the commodity form on the bodies of some ten thousand children.

The novel stages the genesis of the money form in reverse and then forward again. In the shelter after the strike, Stuart McConchie reflects that he had saved cash rather than food or weapons, and he fears ridicule at the relief station for that choice (VI): money dies at the instant of the blast. By 1988 exchange has returned to Marx's elementary form. Eldon Blaine trades eyeglasses for antibiotics (VII), and the economy reconstitutes itself through the expanded form toward a general equivalent, the cigarette, in which other goods express their value.

This is not fancy but a documented regularity. R. A. Radford's classic account of a prisoner-of-war camp showed cigarettes emerging spontaneously as currency, valued for their homogeneity, durability, divisibility, and portability (Radford 1945), and in occupied Germany cigarettes served as a de facto currency until the currency reform of June 1948. The novel recapitulates the historical law with one decisive inflection. The general equivalent of the after-bomb world is a commodity whose use-value is combustion: to be spent, it must be burned. The money of the survivors is fire domesticated. The bomb and the cigarette are two scales of one combustion, the catastrophic and the convivial, and the economic history of the novel is the passage from the first to the second.

1.5 Gift, Poison, Expenditure: Mauss and Bataille

Marcel Mauss demonstrated that the gift is a total social fact governed by three obligations (to give, to receive, to reciprocate) and animated, in the Maori doctrine of the *hau*, by a spirit that compels its return (Mauss 1925). A year earlier, in "Gift, Gift," he had noted that the Germanic word for a present also means poison (Mauss 1924). The council's reward to Hoppy is paid in literal *Gift*: tobacco and liquor, gifts that poison. The ending's enterprise, the automation of Gill's cigarette works, is the industrialization of a poison-gift. Read through Mauss, the Utopia Jameson discerned lies less in the restoration of petty commerce than in the re-ritualization of expenditure.

Georges Bataille's general economy supplies the second term. A society must spend the surplus energy it cannot use for growth, gloriously in luxury, festival, and gift, or catastrophically in war; *La Part maudite* (1949) was written with the Marshall Plan and the nuclear threat explicitly in view, and in 1947 Bataille had reviewed the testimonies of Hiroshima's survivors as evidence of a sovereign sensibility exposed to the instant. Nuclear war is the accursed share spent catastrophically. Andrew Gill is the novel's Bataillean sovereign. At the moment of the strike, having just made love to a stranger, he sees her shoes on the seat of his car and abandons his shop, wife, and children (VI), and he spends the post-war years producing goods consumed for nothing beyond themselves. Those goods are not only tobacco and brandy. Dean Hardy reports that Gill also makes "girly" photographs, and Stuart and Hardy talk of selling pin-up calendars (IX). The after-world reconstitutes the wartime soldier's ration of luxuries (cigarettes, liquor, and pictures of women), so its sovereign expenditure is from the outset an economy in which images of women circulate as goods, a fact that bears directly on Bonny Keller's position in it. The return of luxury is the return of the accursed share as pleasure rather than as war.

Walt Dangerfield's broadcast approaches the gift Derrida described as impossible: given into the air, to listeners unknown, without the possibility of return (Derrida 1991). Yet the novel will not let the gift remain pure. Dick's 1980 afterword describes Dangerfield's transformation from a man who sustains the fragmented society to a

man desperate for its help, and the counter-gift arrives at the close, when Dr. Stockstill begins a psychotherapy that Dangerfield, in good spirits, broadcasts to the world (XVI). The circle of the gift is completed in the medium of the gift.

1.6 Thalidomide and the Idiom of Compensation

Contergan was marketed by Chemie Grünenthal from October 1957 and withdrawn in November 1961. The United States was largely spared because Frances Oldham Kelsey of the Food and Drug Administration withheld approval, for which she received a presidential award in 1962. In West Germany, criminal proceedings against Grünenthal executives opened in 1968 and were halted in 1970 without a verdict, after the firm agreed to pay 100 million marks toward a fund for the injured children. In Britain, the drug's licensee, the Distillers Company, resisted adequate settlement until *The Sunday Times*, under its editor Harold Evans, opened a campaign in September 1972; Distillers settled in 1973. When the British courts enjoined the newspaper's account of how the drug had been developed and tested, the European Court of Human Rights ruled in 1979 that the injunction violated freedom of expression (Sunday Times Insight Team 1979; European Court of Human Rights 1979). "Compensation" thus became the public idiom through which iatrogenic injury was negotiated, and the novel's fictional catastrophe is dated to the year the British campaign began. The coincidence proves nothing; it is an archival rhyme, but one that marks how exactly the novel's imagination tracked the idiom its century was forming.

The other technogenic injury to children was already being measured. From 1958 a citizens' committee in St. Louis collected children's milk teeth to measure the strontium-90 that atmospheric testing had deposited in them, and its findings strengthened the public case for the 1963 test ban. When Stuart assumes Hoppy to be a casualty of the 1972 test, he reaches for the injury his decade had learned to fear. Hoppy's correction names the one it had learned to sell.

Hoppy's correction of his coworker (II) carries the theory. His claim is upon commodity society as such, not upon the warfare state alone, and the compensations he received before the war, a charitable job and a government-issued cart, were compensations in kind that humiliated, as Mauss's analysis of the unreturnable gift predicts. Dick named the dynamic in his own word. His afterword describes Hoppy's hunger for coercive control as "compensation" for what he lacked from birth, and adds that Hoppy, being incomplete, will complete himself at the expense of the entire world (Dick 1980).

1.7 The Homeostatic Trap: Predation as Market

Stuart McConchie's post-war trade is the sale of automated traps built by Dean Hardy, a former radio engineer, against vermin whose intelligence has been enhanced by fal-

lout. To build them he seeks parts salvaged from an undetonated guided missile (VIII). Isaiah's ploughshare becomes a rat trap, and the trap economy is the arms race domesticated: an adaptive weapon against an adaptive enemy, Gregory Bateson's symmetrical schismogenesis reduced to the scale of a barn. Norbert Wiener distinguished the Augustinian devil, nature's indifferent disorder, from the Manichaean devil, an adversary who adapts and deceives (Wiener 1950). Fallout has converted an Augustinian nuisance into a Manichaean opponent, and the trap is a cybernetic weapon. Chapter Six develops the point. Here it suffices that the post-war economy is grafted onto predation: Stuart eats a rat in the shelter (VI), his horse is eaten while he is away (IX), and animals once domestic have formed tribes of their own.

1.8 The Wergild Square

The preceding sections permit a structural reconstruction of the novel's character system around the contradiction of obligation. Let *debt* (S1) and *gift* (S2) be contraries. Their contradictories are *non-gift*, the claim or demand of the creditor (¬S2), and *non-debt*, the innocence of the one who owes nothing (¬S1). Bluthgeld occupies debt, Dangerfield the gift, Hoppy the claim, and Bill Keller, unborn and therefore unindebted, innocence.

The square's derived positions are equally populated. The complex term, debt and gift at once, is the gift that obligates, Mauss's *Gift* as poison. It is occupied by Gill's tobacco and by the community's reciprocal economy of favor and barter, in which Bonny's debt to Bluthgeld and the council's payment to Hoppy circulate. The neutral term, neither debt nor gift, is occupied by beings outside the circuit of obligation: the dead whom Bill hears, the animals that have begun to speak, and the earth's diurnal course itself.

The deixes organize the plot. The positive deixis, debt with claim, is the compensatory economy of debtor and creditor, and the plot executes their conjunction as a murder. The negative deixis, gift with innocence, is an economy of grace, and the plot executes their alliance as a rescue. Both members of the compensatory deixis are enemies of the gift. Bluthgeld's imagined second war aims to silence the talking satellite; Hoppy has been weakening Dangerfield with his emanations in order to seize the satellite's voice (XII–XV). The paranoid debtor would destroy the common voice and the creditor would appropriate it.

The square's resolution is a chiasmus. Bill and Edie first resolve to transfer Bill into Jack Tree, the debtor's body, and are interrupted at the threshold by the creditor's murder of the debtor (XIII). Bill then takes the creditor's body, and the creditor's consciousness dies in the innocent's discarded flesh (XV–XVI). The innocent inherits the creditor's body; the creditor expires in the innocent's. The relation of creditor and debtor is not settled by payment but dissolved by exchange of tenancy.

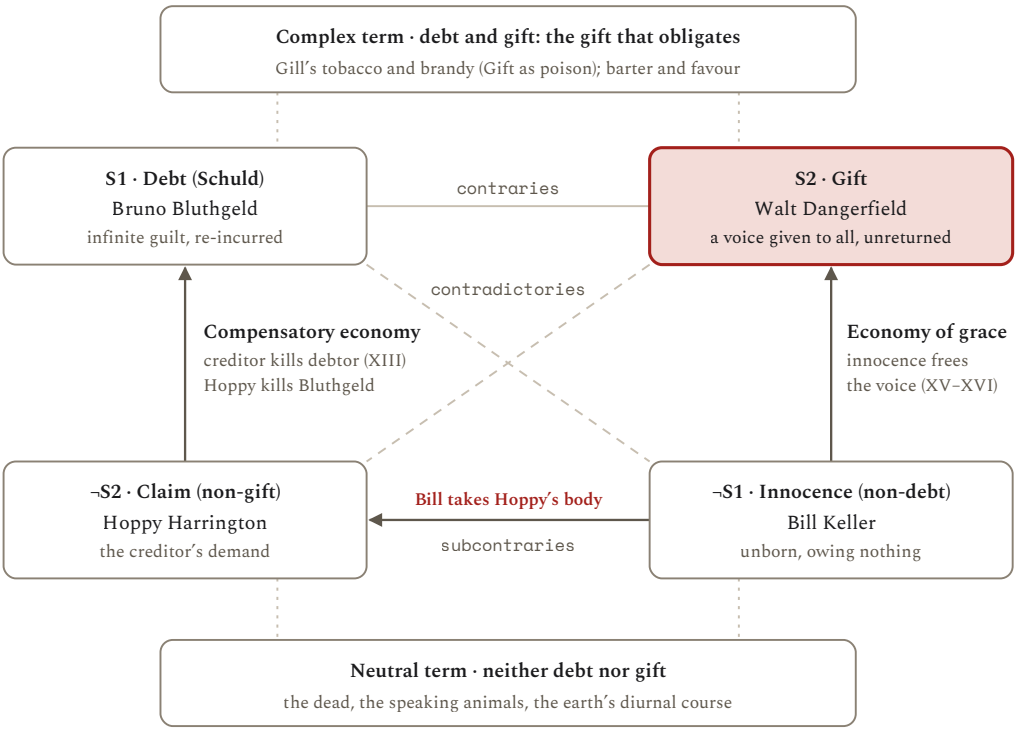


FIGURE 1

The Wergild Square: the cast of Dr. Bloodmoney *on a semiotic square of obligation, after Greimas and Jameson*

The left column is the compensatory economy, whose members destroy each other; the right column is the economy of grace, which frees the common voice; and the bottom arrow is the chiasmus that dissolves the debt without paying it.

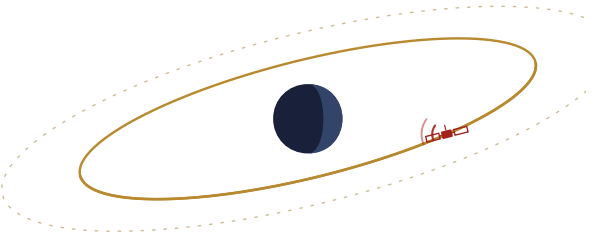
Jameson taught that the square maps the closure of an ideology, the limit of what a text can think. The closure here is the unthinkability of adequate reparation. The novel cannot imagine a payment equal to its catastrophe, and so it exits the economy of compensation altogether through metempsychosis. That limit had a precise historical face in 1963. West Germany's *Wiedergutmachung*, literally a "making good again" codified in the Luxembourg Agreement of 1952, was the era's most consequential and contested attempt to translate an unpayable crime into payment, and the Eichmann trial of 1961 had placed the question of what can be owed for mass death before the world. A novel whose author gave its villain a German name meaning blood money could not have been written outside that question, even where it does not name it.

The German name requires one further precision. Edward Teller, the physicist on whom Bluthgeld is most often modeled, was born into a Jewish family in Budapest and

left Europe in the 1930s, like many of the émigré scientists who built the American bomb. By giving the American bomb-maker a German name, Dick does what Kubrick would do with Strangelove, a German scientist whose arm rises unbidden in a Nazi salute: the culture of 1963–64 located the guilt of its own weapons in a German figure, externalizing the debt onto the nation already marked as the century's debtor. The title's other archetype carries a parallel history. Over centuries of Christian polemic, Judas's thirty pieces were made into an emblem of the Jew as moneylender and betrayer, and blood joined to money became a staple of antisemitic iconography. The novel does not invoke that tradition; at its climax it reverses it, since the apocalypse summoned by the German-named physicist is dispelled by a Yiddish love song (XII). A novel sold as *Dr. Bloodmoney*, and written in the year of *Eichmann in Jerusalem*, has to be read with both the displacement and the reversal in view.

CHAPTER TWO

2



The Paranoid Demiurge

Bluthgeld and the Armed Private World

> *Bluthgeld is the paranoid style with a doctorate and a warhead.*

2.1 The Physicist in the Waiting Room

The novel opens on a sidewalk in Berkeley, where a television salesman sweeping before his shop watches the patients of the psychiatrist next door, and among them the most hated man in the world. Bruno Bluthgeld, whose miscalculation turned a weapons test into an atmospheric catastrophe, believes that people stare at him because they see blotches on his skin, and that they can read his thoughts (I). Dr. Stockstill concludes that his patient hates people. Dick's afterword is blunter still: he confesses that he hates Bluthgeld and everything he represents, that he cannot fathom such a mind, and that what terrifies him is not the Russians but the Bluthgelds of his own society, sick in a way dangerous to everyone else (Dick 1980).

The portrait gestures at Edward Teller, a Hungarian Jewish émigré, champion of the hydrogen bomb, whose testimony in 1954 helped strip J. Robert Oppenheimer of his security clearance (United States Atomic Energy Commission 1954), and cofounder in 1952 of the Livermore laboratory; the novel makes Bonny Keller the physicist's friend and former colleague. But the figure is less a caricature than an institution given a face: the strategic intelligentsia that Kahn's actuarial prose and the RAND Corporation's game theory had made the official mind of the American state. Bluthgeld is what that mind looks like when its premises (assume the adversary's worst intention; prepare for the unthinkable) are held by a single psyche without the professional anaesthesia that makes them bearable.

The strike itself is narrated through his perceptual pathology. Walking through Berkeley with his vision skewed by astigmatism, he sees cracks in buildings and takes them for distortions of his sight, then realizes they are real (V). The private distortion

and the public catastrophe coincide. In the days that follow he concludes that his psychic power caused the war, and he labors to heal the world with the same power until he notices that he has grown a beard (VI). The beard is the index of a time that passed outside the delusion: what Freud, after the Rat Man, called the omnipotence of thoughts (*Allmacht der Gedanken*), measured against a clock it cannot command.

2.2 *Weltuntergang*: Schreber and the Inversion of Recovery

Freud's reading of the memoirs of Daniel Paul Schreber established the paranoid end of the world as a projection: the patient experiences the world's destruction because he has withdrawn his libido from it, and the internal catastrophe is perceived as external. The decisive corollary concerns what follows. The delusion, which we take for the pathological product, is in fact an attempt at recovery, a reconstruction of the world so that the patient can live in it again (Freud 1911). Schreber's world after the catastrophe was peopled by what he called "fleeting-improvised men," shadows assembled for the occasion.

Dr. Bloodmoney turns the theory inside out. The paranoid's world-ending is made public: the projection lands. Freud's two phases, catastrophe and reconstruction, are then distributed across the cast. Bluthgeld remains fixed in the first phase, compelled to re-live it, while the community of West Marin performs the second, the work of rebuilding a world habitable by those who survived the end of one. The novel is Schreber's case narrated from the standpoint of the fleeting-improvised men, who turn out to be real, durable, and capable of saying "we."

The re-enactment of 1988 discloses the structure of the paranoid demand. Seeing Stuart McConchie in West Marin, whom he last saw on the day of the strike, Bluthgeld concludes that the war is about to resume; at the Foresters' Hall he warns Bonny to remove McConchie or he will bring the bombs down again, and her disbelief he experiences as betrayal (XII). What the paranoid demands of the other is belief in his omnipotence. Disbelief is the one wound he cannot absorb, because it restores him to the common world in which he is merely a sick man.

Lacan's account of psychosis supplies the mechanism. What is foreclosed (*verworfen*) from the symbolic order does not return as a repressed memory; it returns in the real (Lacan 1981). The signifier Bluthgeld cannot bear is his own name, which he has exchanged for an alias. The name he forecloses is literally the name of a debt, the paternal ledger of blood. With an exactness no allegory could improve, what is foreclosed from the name returns in the sky as explosion.

2.3 The Private World Armed: Heraclitus, Binswanger, Hofstadter

Heraclitus held that the waking have one world in common (*koinos kosmos*), while each sleeper turns aside into a world of his own (*idios kosmos*) (DK 22 B89). Ludwig Bin-

swanger made the fragment a cornerstone of existential analysis (May, Angel, and Ellenberger 1958), and Dick adopted it in "Schizophrenia & The Book of Changes" (1965) to describe the schizophrenic's fall out of the shared world into a private one. The nuclear strike of 1981 is the instant at which an armed *idios kosmos* becomes everyone's *koinos kosmos*. That is the specific scandal of the nuclear age as the novel diagnoses it: the common world is held hostage by private worlds that command the means of ending it.

Richard Hofstadter delivered "The Paranoid Style in American Politics" as a lecture at Oxford in November 1963, the year of the novel's composition, and published it a year later (Hofstadter 1964). The paranoid spokesman, Hofstadter argued, perceives a vast and preternaturally effective conspiracy and treats each conflict as a final battle for civilization. Bluthgeld is the paranoid style with a doctorate and a warhead, and the novel's joke about an FBI under Nixon that finds him excessive (I) measures how far beyond the political mainstream the style had to travel to become literally apocalyptic.

The psychiatrist's reasoning on the day of the strike exposes the limits of diagnostic reason. Because Bluthgeld believed in an enemy, and Bluthgeld was clearly paranoid, Stockstill reasons, the attack must be an accident (V). The syllogism is itself symptomatic: clinical reason cannot absorb a world in which paranoia is accurate, so it converts the confirmation of the delusion into evidence of chance. The novel's version of the old quip, that paranoids too have enemies, is graver: the paranoid's enemies arrive, and his doctor refuses to believe them.

2.4 Shadow, Inflation, Demiurge: Jung and the Gnostics

Dick read Jung extensively, and Bluthgeld is constructed on two Jungian mechanisms. The first is projection of the Shadow, the disowned destructive potential that the paranoiac locates in an external enemy while it accumulates in himself. The second is inflation, the ego's identification with an archetype larger than itself. Jung's late writings on the atomic age insisted that the fate of the world had come to depend on the unexamined psyche of individuals, and that the bomb had made psychic epidemics a material threat (Jung 1957). *Answer to Job* (1952) had traced the unconsciousness and dark side of the biblical God. Bluthgeld, proclaiming the demolition of existence sanctioned by God (XII), is the inflated ego that takes the dark god's part.

The Gnostic demiurge, reconstructed for Dick's generation by Hans Jonas's *The Gnostic Religion* (1958), is the ignorant creator who boasts that there is no god beside him. Bluthgeld is the first of Dick's demiurges, maker and unmaker of a world he mistakes for his property. His heirs are Palmer Eldritch, the prosthetic god of the 1965 novel; Carleton Lufteufel, the "air-devil" whose war makes him an object of worship in *Deus Irae* (1976); and the Empire of *VALIS* (1981). The line from Bluthgeld to the Black

Iron Prison is continuous: the world as the projection of a sick, powerful, and ignorant mind.

2.5 The Promethean Gap: Anders, Eatherly, and Eichmann

Günther Anders diagnosed a "Promethean gap" between what modern humanity can produce and what it can imagine, feel, or take responsibility for: we can make a weapon that kills a city, but we cannot feel the deaths of a city (Anders 1956). His correspondence with Claude Eatherly, the reconnaissance pilot who had signaled clear weather over Hiroshima and whose subsequent guilt led to petty crimes and repeated psychiatric confinement, argued that Eatherly's guilt was the sane response and the diagnosis of his doctors the pathology (Anders and Eatherly 1961).

Bluthgeld is Anders's case turned inside out. In him the Promethean gap is closed by delirium: he feels not too little but too much, and his guilt metastasizes into omnipotence. Dick's afterword withholds the sympathy Anders extended to Eatherly, and the novel locates the distinction precisely. Bluthgeld's guilt is real, but his response to guilt is hatred and grandiosity rather than repentance. He persecutes rather than atones. Before the war he had a pacifist colleague, Austurias, dismissed from the university (IV), a miniature of the 1954 hearing at which Teller, the hydrogen bomb's champion, testified against Oppenheimer, its most prominent doubter; and the paranoid's guilt about the dead coexists with contempt for the living.

Hannah Arendt's *Eichmann in Jerusalem*, serialized in the spring of 1963, supplies the antithesis. Eichmann's evil was banal: a thoughtlessness that rendered him incapable of thinking from the standpoint of anyone else (Arendt 1963). Bluthgeld thinks in excess, but only from his own standpoint, enlarged to cosmic scale. The two figures are the year's twin pathologies of responsibility, the functionary who feels nothing and the scientist who feels everything, and both fail the test Arendt took from Kant's enlarged mentality, the capacity to think in the place of others. Both are worldless. Eichmann's clichés and Bluthgeld's delusions equally foreclose the common world. Arendt's earlier diagnosis completes the portrait. Modern science, she argued, has begun to act into nature from an Archimedean point outside the earth, unleashing on the planet processes that occur only in the sun (Arendt 1958). Bluthgeld's miscalculation in the upper atmosphere is that action, the physicist reaching into the sky to bring a star's fire down.

2.6 Cain the Shepherd: Tree, Terry, and the Mark

In 1988 Bluthgeld lives outside the community under the name Jack Tree, herding sheep for their wool, guarded by a dog named Terry that can imitate human speech (VIII). The biblical palimpsest is exact. Abel was a keeper of sheep and Cain a tiller of the ground (Gen. 4:2). The first murderer is marked by God, "lest any finding him

should kill him" (Gen. 4:15), and Bluthgeld's imagined blotches, the stigmata he believes all can see (I), are the mark of Cain hallucinated onto a guilty skin. The murderer of millions hides in the vocation of the first murdered man.

The mark protects as well as condemns, and so does West Marin. Between the fourth and eighth chapters, the schoolteacher Austurias, the pacifist whom Bluthgeld had once had dismissed from the university, is exposed by Bonny Keller as having come to West Marin in pursuit of the physicist, and is summarily executed (IV, VIII). The text does not say who carried out the execution; what it makes plain is that Bonny's exposure delivered him to it. A second Abel, the very man Cain once persecuted, dies so that Cain may stay hidden. The diurnal commons, in other words, is founded like every polity on a killing it prefers not to narrate, a point Chapter Three develops through René Girard.

The alias is a cryptonym in the strict sense, a word that hides the unmourned. It encrypts the tree of knowledge from which the physicist ate, and the tree of Calvary, the gibbet on which the price of blood was paid. Above all it encrypts the line that closes the Wordsworth poem from which Dick drew his working title: the dead girl "Rolled round in earth's diurnal course, / With rocks, and stones, and trees." Bluthgeld's alias expresses a wish to become a thing among things, to vanish into the earth's indifferent rotation as Lucy does, and so escape the gaze he dreads. That dread is an inverted Berkeleianism. If to be is to be perceived, the paranoiac who cannot bear to be perceived wishes not to be. The tree is idealism's own example: the limerick attributed to Ronald Knox makes Berkeley's God the perceiver who keeps a tree in a college quad in being when no one else is looking. The physicist who hides as Tree hides inside the one object philosophy made famous for persisting only under a gaze.

2.7 Constellations: Hoenikker, Strangelove, Solaris, Lathe

Kurt Vonnegut's *Cat's Cradle*, published in 1963, gives the nuclear scientist as a child. Felix Hoenikker, a father of the bomb, invents ice-nine with the incurious delight of a boy at play and leaves his children to end the world with it. Kubrick's Strangelove, released in January 1964, embodies a third posture, the libido of annihilation: a scientist aroused by the doomsday calculus, whose gloved hand rebels against him, rising in a Nazi salute and turning to strangle him. With Bluthgeld, these figures form a triad of the satirical imagination of 1963–64. Hoenikker is the Promethean gap without remainder, guiltless; Strangelove is the gap eroticized; Bluthgeld is the gap with infinite remainder, guilt become delirium. Apathy, eros, paranoia: the three affective postures the culture could imagine for the men who built the bomb.

Stanisław Lem, who in 1975 hailed Dick as a visionary among charlatans, had published *Solaris* in 1961. Its ocean materializes the repressed guilts of the scientists who study it, so that Kelvin's dead wife returns to his cabin. In Lem the world materializes guilt; in Dick guilt appears to materialize a world. Ursula K. Le Guin's *The Lathe of*

Heaven (1971), widely read as her most Dickian novel, gives a man whose dreams alter reality and a psychiatrist, Haber, who exploits them for utopian engineering until the dreams produce plague and alien war. The comparison illuminates Stockstill, whose name names the analyst's abstention. Where Haber intervenes, Stockstill withholds: examining Edie, he decides not to tell her parents that the growth inside her is conscious (IX). The Taoist ethic of non-action that Le Guin opposes to Haber's will to improve has a modest Californian double in the psychiatrist who keeps still.

Tzvetan Todorov defined the fantastic as the reader's hesitation between natural and supernatural explanations (Todorov 1970). Dick sustains that hesitation about Bluthgeld's power to the end. In 1988 an explosion lights the sky, Dangerfield sees a flash on the horizon, his broadcast stops and his capsule shudders (XII–XIII). The hesitation is the novel's political content: in the nuclear age the difference between a psyche and a weapon has become undecidable, because psyches command weapons. What dispels the second apocalypse is not argument but a song. Dangerfield's broadcast resumes with "Bei Mir Bist Du Schön," a Yiddish theater song whose title declares that to me you are beautiful, and the physicist leaves the hall confused (XII). By most accounts the song's composers had sold its rights for a pittance in 1937 and recovered them only on renewal in 1961: a song whose own history is a parable of value returning, uncompensated for decades, to those who made it.

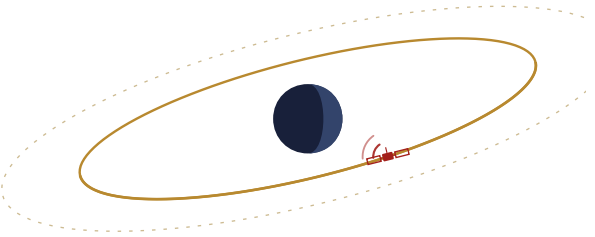
2.8 The Wrathful Deities

The *Bardo Thödol* instructs the dead, as peaceful and then wrathful deities appear in the intermediate state, to recognize them as projections of their own mind; failure to recognize them produces terror, flight, and rebirth in a lower realm (Evans-Wentz 1927). Bluthgeld is the consciousness that cannot recognize its own projections. The bombs he fears and summons are the wrathful deities of his own intellect, and he alternately flees them into hiding and calls them down in rage. His death is a parody of ascension: Hoppy flings him into the air and lets him fall (XIII), and the physicist who acted into nature from the heavens is lifted to heaven and dropped, Isaiah's "How art thou fallen from heaven, O Lucifer" (Isa. 14:12) enacted as telekinesis.

Giorgio Agamben's *homo sacer* is the one whom anyone may kill without committing homicide, and who stands in symmetry with the sovereign, for whom all are potentially *homines sacri* (Agamben 1995). Universally hated, already sheltered by a killing, Bluthgeld is the novel's *homo sacer*. His death at Hoppy's hands is the founding act of a would-be sovereignty, and the community's payment to his killer is its first, involuntary act of homage. The next chapter follows the creditor who became a king.

CHAPTER THREE

3



The Exception and the Sovereign

Hoppy Harrington and Ventriloquial Power

> *He is the exception who would decide the exception.*

3.1 Hoppy, Hopalong, and the Cart

Jim Fergesson, owner of Modern TV Sales and Service, hires without regard to race or body: Stuart McConchie, a Black salesman, and Hoppy Harrington, a phocomelus who arrives on a government-built cart with mechanical extensors (I–II). Stuart considers the hire bad for business and assumes Hoppy's condition a legacy of the 1972 test, an assumption Hoppy corrects: thalidomide, 1964 (II). At his bench Hoppy repairs a spring without touching it, and Fergesson suspects that he can somehow heal machines. In defiance of the owner's ban on drinking he takes a beer at lunch and falls into a trance from which he returns spent (III).

By 1988 he is West Marin's indispensable mechanic and electrician, his servo-mechanical extensors supplemented by a psychokinetic power that grows by the month. After one of Dangerfield's broadcasts he performs a perfect imitation of the astronaut; he entertains with telekinetic coin tricks; and the community's leader, June Raub, warns a visitor that Hoppy could kill him and would not mind (X). The visitor, Eldon Blaine of Bolinas, tries to steal Hoppy's radio transmitter, and Hoppy breaks his neck with an extensor (X).

The name repays attention. "Hoppy" was the nickname of Hopalong Cassidy, the cowboy Clarence E. Mulford created in 1904 and named for the limp a bullet had left him. William Boyd's screen Hopalong, from 1949 the first great merchandising hero of American television, soon discarded the limp that had furnished the name. The television age kept the name of a disability while erasing the disability, and Dick's television repairman restores the disability to the name. The heir of the frontier hero, on the

post-frontier of a ruined West, is a limbless technician who rules by action at a distance, which was always the gunfighter's essence: to kill without touching.

3.2 The Exception: Freud's Richard III

Freud's 1916 essay on character types opens with "The Exceptions": patients who refuse a necessary renunciation on the ground that they have already suffered enough, having sustained in childhood an injury for which they hold fate responsible (Freud 1916). His exemplar is the opening soliloquy of *Richard III*, in which Gloucester describes himself as "Deform'd, unfinish'd, sent before my time / Into this breathing world, scarce half made up" (1.1.20–21). Freud paraphrases the subtext: nature has wronged me by denying me the form that wins love, life owes me reparation, and I will collect it; I have a right to be an exception. He adds that the speech wins our sympathy because each of us harbors a narcissistic wound of the same kind.

Hoppy is Richard in the idiom of 1963. Richard boasts in *3 Henry VI* that he can "add colours to the chameleon, / Change shapes with Proteus," and Hoppy's instrument is the same: mimicry, the deformed man's mastery of masks. Dick's own diagnosis of Hoppy as "incomplete" (Dick 1980) translates Richard's "unfinish'd" and "scarce half made up" almost word for word. And Dick's insistence that Hoppy's power, rather than Hoppy, is evil reproduces Freud's point about our sympathy: the reader is implicated in the claim even while recoiling from its execution.

3.3 Organ Inferiority and the Phantom "I Can": Adler and Merleau-Ponty

Alfred Adler's study of organ inferiority (1907) proposed that a constitutional deficit provokes compensation and, often, overcompensation, and his mature psychology made the striving for superiority the master motive of neurotic life. Hoppy's telekinesis is compensation literalized: the missing organ's function performed by a capacity that exceeds any organ. Dick's afterword names it "compensation" in Adler's own word (Dick 1980).

Merleau-Ponty's analysis of the phantom limb deepens the point. The amputee's phantom persists because the body schema preserves an "I can," a motor intentionality directed at a world that solicits action, and consciousness is in the first instance not an "I think" but an "I can" (Merleau-Ponty 1945). Hoppy never had limbs, so his "I can" was never anchored in organs. Telekinesis is that "I can" freed from flesh: an omnipotent phantom limb. The danger the novel registers lies exactly here. Limbs impose limits of reach, fatigue, and proximity that bind power to touch; Hoppy's power has none of them, and an "I can" without a body has no reason to stop.

3.4 Ressentiment: Nietzsche, Scheler, Deleuze

The first essay of the *Genealogy* describes the man of ressentiment as one whose soul squints, who loves hiding places and secret paths, and whose revolt becomes creative when ressentiment begins to give birth to values (Nietzsche 1887, I.10). Max Scheler refined the diagnosis: ressentiment requires the conjunction of impotence and repressed revenge, and when the impotent acquire power it converts into open revenge (Scheler 1912). Hoppy is Scheler's case in its second phase. Patronized and pitied before the war, he nursed a quiet resentment of the condescension he endured. The catastrophe that destroyed the world that pitied him gave him power, and the resentment discharged as domination.

Gilles Deleuze's *Nietzsche et la philosophie* (1962) supplies the decisive refinement. Reactive forces may triumph without becoming active; they triumph by separating active force from what it can do. Hoppy's power, however great, remains reactive. It is defined by what it negates, oriented to the humiliation of others rather than to creation, and its one creative act, mimicry, is reproduction: he does not speak in his own voice but in Dangerfield's. This is why West Marin fears him even after he saves it. A reactive force can conquer, but it cannot give.

3.5 The Survivor's Power: Canetti

Elias Canetti's *Crowds and Power* (1960) located the root of power in survival: the moment of survival is the moment of power, and the man who stands alive among the dead feels himself unique and chosen. The despot accumulates survivals, and the paranoiac Schreber, whose delusion left him the last man alive, is Canetti's model of the ruler's inner life. Hoppy survives the strike protected by television cartons while his employer is cut in two above him (V): he lives through the end of the world sheltered in the packaging of the commodities he was hired to repair. His trance of 1981 had shown him the post-war world, which he mistook for the realm beyond the grave (III, VI). He has seen the future as the land of the dead and himself thriving in it, which is the survivor's vision exactly.

Canetti's "sting" of command completes the portrait. Every order leaves a sting in the one who executes it, and the sting persists until it can be discharged by giving orders in turn. Hoppy was the object of commands, Fergesson's prohibition among them (III), and of charity, which is command disguised as gift. By 1988 he discharges stored stings as commands of his own, and each death he causes (Blaine, then Bluthgeld) accumulates survival in Canetti's sense, deepening an invulnerability that the community's reward only confirms.

3.6 Personation and the Exception: Hobbes, Schmitt, Kantorowicz

Hobbes derived the person from the stage. *Persona* in Latin, he observed, signifies the disguise or outward appearance of a man counterfeited on the stage, and "A multitude of men, are made one person, when they are by one man, or one person, represented" (Hobbes 1651, ch. 16). The frontispiece of *Leviathan* shows a giant composed of many small bodies, and the novel supplies its grotesque literalization in the "symbiotics," survivors fused into one flesh, whom Stuart now loathes more than phocomeli (VIII).

Dangerfield's voice is the one person by which a dispersed multitude is represented to itself, and Hoppy's plan is to become that person by counterfeit. He intends to use the transmitter and his gift for imitation to replace Dangerfield should the astronaut die (X); later, while Dangerfield still lives, he seizes the satellite and uses Dangerfield's own voice to boast of having killed Bluthgeld (XV). Dangerfield, recording what he believes to be his dying message, finds the tape blank and hears his own voice on the air explaining that his trouble was only indigestion (XV). This is ventriloquial sovereignty in its pure form: sovereignty as the theatrical counterfeit of the common voice.

Carl Schmitt defined the sovereign as he who decides on the exception (Schmitt 1922), and the survivors call the war "the Emergency," the state of exception made permanent. Hoppy fuses Freud's exception, the injured party who claims exemption, with Schmitt's, the sovereign who decides when the rules are suspended. He is the exception who would decide the exception. Ernst Kantorowicz's study of the king's two bodies (1957) completes the analysis. At a king's death, the body politic passes to a new body natural. The climax of the novel splits Hoppy's two bodies without succession: his body natural passes to Bill Keller, the voice he usurped returns to Dangerfield, and the person who sought the office dies in a fetal cyst (XV–XVI). The demise yields no new king. The body is released from the office it sought.

3.7 Miracle, Mystery, Authority: Dostoevsky and Girard

Dostoevsky's Grand Inquisitor rules by three powers, miracle, mystery, and authority, and by the bread with which he relieves humanity of freedom. Hoppy's repertoire matches it item for item. His miracles are telekinetic: machines healed without touch. His mystery is the trance beyond the grave, which makes him feared as one who knows death. His authority is the voice from the sky, and his bread is electricity and repair, on which the community's survival depends. In the legend, Christ answers the Inquisitor with a silent kiss. In the novel, Hoppy is undone by a being with no voice of his own, who speaks only in the voices of the dead and defeats him without argument.

Dostoevsky had drawn the earlier stages of the same trajectory. The narrator of *Notes from Underground* (1864) is a man of acute consciousness and wounded pride who would rather suffer than be pitied, and the theorist Shigalyov in *Demons* (1871–72) ad-

mits, in Constance Garnett's 1916 rendering, that "starting from unlimited freedom, I arrive at unlimited despotism." Hoppy passes through all three figures in order: the underground man of 1981, nursing slights at a workbench; the Shigalyovian organizer of a post-war freedom that depends on his indispensability; and finally the Inquisitor, governing by miracle, mystery, and authority.

René Girard's theory of mimetic desire supplies the social mechanism (Girard 1972). Desire copies the desire of a model, the model becomes a rival, and the mimetic crisis is resolved when the community unites against a victim whose death restores order and who is afterwards sacralized. Hoppy's desire is mimetic in the strictest sense: he imitates Dangerfield's voice and desires Dangerfield's place, and the model becomes the rival he slowly kills. The community's victims form a series. Austurias is executed; Bluthgeld, the universally hated, is killed, and his killer is rewarded with gifts and a monument, the first step of a deification that makes Bonny fear a vindictive little tin god; and Hoppy becomes in turn the object of collective dread, as Bonny proposes killing him (XIV).

The novel exposes the scapegoat mechanism rather than consecrating it. The community's violence is narrated, its payments are scorned, and its deliverance comes not from a collective murder but from the act of the one being outside the mimetic economy: an unborn child who desires not another's place but the capacity to perceive.

3.8 Narrative Prosthesis and Its Discontents

David Mitchell and Sharon Snyder named "narrative prosthesis" the dependence of literary narrative on disability as a crutch for meaning, typically resolved by the disability's cure or the disabled character's elimination (Mitchell and Snyder 2000). Paul Longmore catalogued the disabled villain driven to avenge his condition on the world (Longmore 1985), and Leslie Fiedler, Rosemarie Garland-Thomson, and Tobin Siebers have anatomized the cultural uses of the extraordinary body (Fiedler 1978; Garland-Thomson 1997; Siebers 2008). Hoppy fits the avenger stereotype disturbingly well, and the critique must be stated plainly: the novel makes a congenitally disabled man the vessel of tyranny, and its resolution requires his elimination.

Three features nonetheless complicate the case. The first is etiology. The novel locates Hoppy's evil in ressentiment produced by social humiliation (the condescending hire, Stuart's open disgust, the charity cart), and Dick insists that the power, not the person, is evil. The second is re-tenancy. The climax does not eliminate the disabled body; it re-inhabits it. Bill Keller, a being more radically disabled than Hoppy (without sight, hearing, or locomotion, dependent on his sister's perceptions), takes possession of the phocomelus body and experiences it as birth. The body that served ressentiment becomes the vehicle of wonder, and the narrative separates disability from ressentiment, eliminating the latter while affirming the former. The third is revision. In *Deus Irae*, begun in 1964 and completed with Roger Zelazny, Dick made a limbless painter,

Tibor McMasters, the pilgrim-hero who travels in a cart drawn by a cow to paint the god of the war.

Yet the critique is not dissolved. Re-tenancy is a fantasy of exorcism: the novel can affirm the disabled body only by evicting the disabled person, and it imagines the body "freed" from the subjectivity that inhabited it. Siebers's account of disability as masquerade (Siebers 2004) sharpens the irony. Hoppy's masquerade is not of disability but of ability: he performs the voice of an able-bodied astronaut. The novel's justice requires that the mask be stripped, and in stripping it the novel cannot avoid stripping the man.

The novel also refuses to make its commons an egalitarian refuge. Stuart's revulsion toward "phoces," the clipped and contemptuous word the novel's characters use for phocomeli, is not cured by catastrophe but displaced onto symbiotics (VIII); he hesitates to move to the countryside for fear of racism (IX); and the local editor knows he cannot print that a Negro, in the period's term, met with Andrew Gill (XI). Prejudice is conserved through the end of the world and merely redistributed. The diurnal commons is not a utopia of recognition. It is a place where getting along remains work.

3.9 Constellations: Strangelove's Rising, Sturgeon's Gestalt, Butler's Hyperempathy, Prospero's Isle

In the last scene of *Dr. Strangelove*, the wheelchair-bound strategist rises as the doomsday machine detonates and announces to the President, whom he addresses as his Führer, that he can walk. Dick's novel, completed before the film's release, contains its structural twin: the post-bomb world heals Hoppy by converting his deficit into power. Kubrick's joke and Dick's narrative share a nightmare, catastrophe as the miraculous cure that turns a disabled body into a sovereign one. Dick's novel also divides Strangelove in two. The German-named scientist of the apocalypse becomes Bluthgeld; the disabled body that rises with it becomes Hoppy. What Kubrick fused into one grotesque, Dick separates into a debtor and a creditor and sets against each other.

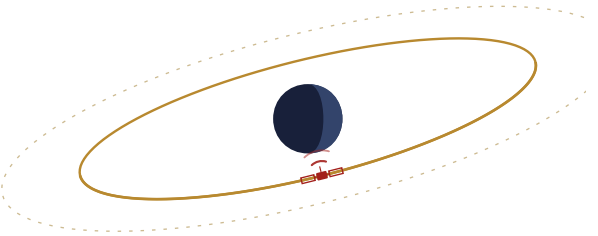
Theodore Sturgeon's *More Than Human* (1953) assembles a gestalt of misfits, an idiot, a telekinetic girl, teleporting twins, and an infant who computes, into a collective organism that must acquire an ethos before it can be more than a predator. Hoppy is the gifted misfit without ethos, and West Marin, a community of odd talents, acquires its ethos only by expelling him. John Wyndham's *The Chrysalids* (1955) sets a purity cult that hunts "deviations" against telepathic children rescued by an emissary whose evolutionary ethic, that the new species must supplant the old, is itself chilling. Dick declines both the purity cult and the supersession myth, as he declines the persecuted elites of Olaf Stapledon's *Odd John* (1935) and A. E. van Vogt's *Slan* (1940): mutation in *Dr. Bloodmoney* is normalized within a heterogeneous commons, and the danger is not difference but the will to dominate.

Octavia E. Butler's *Parable of the Sower* (1993) gives its heroine a "hyperempathy syndrome," a congenital condition caused by her mother's abuse of a pharmaceutical, which compels her to feel the pain she witnesses. Hoppy and Lauren Olamina are two congenital pharmacological anomalies issuing in opposed capacities: telekinesis, power at a distance without contact, and hyperempathy, contact without distance. The ethical topology of the post-catastrophe body runs between these poles, and Dick's own later Mercerism, in which a technology fuses its users in shared suffering (Dick 1968), moves from the first toward the second.

Shakespeare's *Tempest* frames the whole. Hoppy is a Caliban who would be Prospero, the island's misshapen servant turned magus. Dangerfield is its Ariel, the spirit of the air who makes music. Caliban hears the isle as "full of noises, / Sounds and sweet airs, that give delight and hurt not" (3.2.135–36); Hoppy does not listen to the island's music but seeks to own it. West Marin itself rides the Point Reyes peninsula, a fragment of the Pacific plate drifting northwest along the San Andreas fault, an island in all but water, and the drama of its would-be magus is the drama of every isle in which a castaway mistakes his power for his right.

CHAPTER FOUR

4



The Voice in the Sky

Dangerfield and the Constitution of a Common World

> *The giver becomes the one in need, and the commons proves itself a commons when it answers.*

4.1 The Disc Jockey of the Spheres

Walt and Lydia Dangerfield are launched on the day of the strike as the first colonists bound for Mars. At a crucial stage of the ascent their ground contact reports an attack and falls silent, and Dangerfield looks down to see fires on the surface of the earth (V). Stranded in orbit with rations for years and a library of books and recordings, he becomes the world's disc jockey. He reads Maugham's *Of Human Bondage* to survivors gathered in the Foresters' Hall (IV), takes requests, relays handyman tips, and gives the weather (VII). His wife has taken her own life; he suffers chest pains and wonders at his own endurance (VII); and the communities below dread his death (X). His pain, he notices, is always worst over northern California (XV), where Hoppy sits at his transmitter.

Dick's afterword traces his reversal from the man who sustains a fragmented society, giving it unity and morale, to a man desperate for its help, and reads him as the emblem of isolation, the horror of those below who have lost the objects and values that composed their world (Dick 1980). The reversal is the hinge of the novel's economy of voice. The giver becomes the one in need, and the commons proves itself a commons when it answers.

His capsule is named the *Dutchman IV*. The legend of the Flying Dutchman tells of a captain condemned to sail until the Day of Judgment, unable to make port. In Wagner's opera of 1843, the curse is lifted by a woman's fidelity unto death: Senta throws herself into the sea, the ship sinks, and the lovers rise transfigured. Dick, whose late fiction is saturated with Wagner's *Parsifal*, rewrites the redemption. Lydia's suicide re-

deems nothing, and the capsule circles on. Redemption, insofar as the novel grants it, comes not from a woman's sacrifice but from a community's listening and a psychiatrist's speech (XVI). The Dutchman's curse, to circle until Judgment, is orbital eschatology in mythic form: the end deferred into a perpetual round.

4.2 The Common Logos: Heraclitus and the Waking World

Heraclitus taught that although the *logos* is common (*xunos*), the many live as though they had a private understanding (DK 22 B2), and that those who speak with understanding must hold fast to what is common to all, as a city holds fast to its law (B114). Dangerfield's broadcast is the common *logos* re-materialized as signal. The survivors live in private worlds in more than a psychological sense. Their settlements are dispersed, their councils view one another with hostility, and Bolinas schemes to kidnap West Marin's technician (VII). For the duration of a pass overhead, the broadcast wakes them into one world.

The broadcast is thus the structural antithesis of Bluthgeld. The paranoid privatizes the cosmos; the disc jockey publicizes it. Bluthgeld's imagined second war is aimed, significantly, at silencing the talking satellite: the armed *idios kosmos* recognizes in the common voice its enemy, and the city's law, in Heraclitus' figure, is the law of hearing in common.

4.3 Earth Alienation Reversed: Arendt

Arendt opened *The Human Condition* (1958) with the launch in 1957 of an earth-born object into the universe, and with the relief, voiced by a reporter, at a first step toward escape from humanity's imprisonment to the earth. In that relief she read the culmination of "earth alienation," the wish to exchange the given human condition for one of our own making. Dangerfield was to have been the agent of that escape, and the strike arrests him in orbit. The man launched to leave the earth becomes the voice that binds its survivors. The novel reverses Arendt's trajectory: flight from the earth is converted into circling around it, earth alienation into earth-binding.

Arendt figured the world as an in-between that relates and separates, like a table around which people sit, and diagnosed mass society as a séance in which the table has vanished and people sit opposite one another with nothing between them. The broadcast restores the table. It relates the dispersed survivors while preserving their separateness, and the Foresters' Hall is its acoustic form. Arendt's space of appearance is visual and agonistic; the novel's is auditory and convivial, a space of audition in which persons appear to one another as co-listeners. The satellite occupies Arendt's Archimedean point literally, yet Dangerfield's view from above yields not domination but witness. He sees the fires and grieves, and the vantage that science had used to act into nature is converted into a vantage for testimony.

4.4 Seriality and the Group: Sartre

In the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960) Sartre made radio listeners an example of the series: each listener alone, unified only by a voice that addresses all and to which none can reply, a collectivity constituted by the practico-inert. The series becomes a group-in-fusion in moments of common praxis, of which the storming of the Bastille is the paradigm; the group then pledges itself, binding its members by an oath whose guarantee is what Sartre called fraternity-terror; it organizes, institutionalizes, and finally concentrates its unity in a sovereign who claims to embody it and thereby re-serializes the members.

The novel enacts this dialectic in acoustic form. The listeners do not remain serial: they gather physically in the Foresters' Hall, where they argue, hush one another, and praise the broadcaster (IV, X, XII), and listening becomes common praxis. The council is the pledged group, and the schoolteacher executed after Bonny's denunciation measures the terror that guards its bond. Hoppy's usurpation is Sartre's final stage, sovereignty: the seizure of the group's unity by an individual who claims to embody its voice, which would return the listeners to seriality as subjects of a voice they cannot answer. Sartre supplies the political grammar of the novel's acoustic drama.

4.5 The Tribal Drum: McLuhan and Ong

McLuhan's chapter on radio in *Understanding Media* (1964) is titled "The Tribal Drum." Radio, he argued, retribalizes: it creates an acoustic space at once intimate and collective, and his paradigm of its mobilizing force is Hitler's use of the wireless. *The Gutenberg Galaxy* (1962) had already announced the electric restoration of the ear's primacy over the eye and coined the global village. After the collapse of print and television, the culture of West Marin retribalizes around a single radio voice, and the hall is McLuhan's village.

The novel stages both faces of the drum within one medium. Dangerfield's is intimate, comic, and plural, assembled from requests, tips, weather, and records. Hoppy's is the voice of the radio dictator, a single throat for a mobilized people. The same drum can summon a commons or a *Volk*, and the novel's politics is the struggle over which. Walter Ong's "secondary orality" names the condition precisely (Ong 1982): a technologically sustained orality, participatory and formulaic, in which a community reconstitutes itself around a voice it cannot see.

Pierre Teilhard de Chardin, whose *Phenomenon of Man* reached English readers in 1959, imagined a noosphere, a thinking envelope closing over the planet, and McLuhan described electric media as a nervous system extended around the globe. Dangerfield's capsule is the noosphere reduced to its last strand: not a convergence of minds but one fragile voice, which a single act of violence in the sky could cut (Teilhard de Chardin 1955).

4.6 The Storyteller in Orbit: Benjamin

Walter Benjamin's "The Storyteller" (1936) argued that storytelling, the transmission of experience from mouth to mouth, had declined to the point that soldiers returned from the Great War silent, poorer in communicable experience. The novel, born of the solitary individual, could not be shared as a story is shared, and the storyteller's authority derives from death, the sanction of everything he can tell. Dangerfield inverts that history. He reads a novel, the genre of the solitary reader, aloud to listeners gathered in a hall, and so converts it back into a story heard in common. His authority is the one Benjamin named. He has watched the fires from above, his wife is dead by her own hand, and he believes himself to be dying: a storyteller who has come close to death and returns with communicable experience.

Benjamin's own radio work between 1927 and 1933 included talks for children on catastrophes: the Lisbon earthquake, the destruction of Herculaneum and Pompeii, the railway disaster on the Firth of Tay, the Mississippi flood of 1927. Radio, for Benjamin, was the medium through which catastrophe could be narrated to the young. In West Marin a seven-year-old girl tells stories to the brother inside her (IX) and asks for a story on his behalf (X). The children of the after-world receive it as narrative.

The ninth thesis on the concept of history (1940) supplies the image. Klee's angel faces the past and sees one single catastrophe piling wreckage at his feet; he would like to stay, awaken the dead, and make whole what has been smashed, but a storm from Paradise called progress drives him irresistibly into the future. Dangerfield is that angel, suspended above the wreckage and unable to land, driven by the storm of progress that launched him toward Mars. The novel divides the angel's wish among its figures. Dangerfield sees the wreckage; Bill, who hears the dead, awakens them in the only sense available; and the community makes whole what can be made whole.

4.7 *Of Human Bondage*: Spinoza in the Foresters' Hall

Maugham took the title of his 1915 novel from the fourth part of Spinoza's *Ethics*, "Of Human Bondage, or the Strength of the Emotions" (*De Servitute Humana, seu de Affectuum Viribus*). Its hero, Philip Carey, has a congenital club foot, is humiliated at school, and is enslaved by a ruinous passion. A poet bequeaths him a Persian rug said to contain the meaning of life, and Philip finally understands that life has no meaning, and that he may weave a pattern from his experiences as a weaver makes a rug, for the beauty of the pattern alone.

The choice of text is overdetermined in three ways. Each evening the community hears the story of a congenitally deformed man whose bitterness does not become tyranny, a mirror held up to Hoppy and a corrective to him. The novel's title names the condition of its principal figures, Bluthgeld bound by fear, Hoppy by envy, Bonny by a succession of affairs, with Gill in 1981 and Barnes in 1988, and a daydream of the as-

tronaut himself (II, VI, XII). And the rug is the figure of the post-war community, which weaves a pattern of life without transcendent warrant: getting along as weaving.

Spinoza's own doctrine completes the reading. Bondage is passivity, determination by external causes through inadequate ideas; freedom is the activity of understanding; the essence of each thing is its striving (*conatus*) to persevere in its being (*Ethics* III, P6); and joy is the passage to a greater power of acting, sadness to a lesser (III, P11, scholium). Deleuze drew the political consequence: the tyrant, the priest, and the slave share a need for sad passions, and the tyrant requires the sadness of souls in order to triumph (Deleuze 1970). Hoppy's regime runs on fear. Dangerfield's comedy, music, and requests produce joyful passions that increase the community's power to act. "Getting along" is the *conatus* of a collectivity, and the Foresters' Hall is a laboratory of joyful affect. The novel's political theory of affect is Spinozist: a commons sustained by joy is threatened by a sovereignty that feeds on fear.

4.8 The Acousmêtre and the Music of the Spheres

Michel Chion named the *acousmêtre* the voice whose source is not seen, and attributed to it four powers: ubiquity, panopticism, omniscience, and omnipotence; when its source is revealed, a de-acousmatization strips the powers away (Chion 1982). The term descends through Pierre Schaeffer from the *akousmatikoi*, the Pythagorean disciples said to have heard their master's voice from behind a veil. Rossi has placed Dangerfield at the head of a lineage of acousmatic broadcasters in American fiction (Rossi 2009). He is a benign acousmêtre. He does see all from orbit, but he spends the vantage on witness and practical counsel. Hoppy's ambition is to become an acousmêtre by counterfeit, and his undoing begins in a de-acousmatization: listening in Berkeley, Bonny recognizes that the voice boasting of Bluthgeld's death is not Dangerfield's (XV).

The Pythagoreans held that the planets sound as they move, producing a harmony humans cannot hear because it has sounded since birth; Boethius called it *musica mundana*, and Kepler sought its ratios in *Harmonices Mundi* (1619). Dangerfield's capsule is a technical realization of the music of the spheres: a sphere circling the earth that sounds, playing Bach while it shudders under the second apocalypse (XIII). The Pythagorean music is inaudible because it never stops. Dangerfield's is audible because it passes. Intermittence is the condition of hearing, and the diurnal course is the rhythm of a cosmos that can at last be heard.

4.9 Telstar, Starfish, and the Fragile Orbital Commons

Telstar relayed the first live transatlantic television in July 1962. Within months, the artificial radiation belt created by Starfish Prime and subsequent high-altitude tests had degraded its transistors, and it failed in February 1963. Meanwhile the Tornados'

instrumental "Telstar," produced by Joe Meek, topped the British and American charts, so the satellite became a pop record. Dangerfield is Telstar personified: the orbiting relay as disc jockey. His vulnerability to Bluthgeld's explosions and Hoppy's emanations restages the historical vulnerability of the first communications satellites to the bomb. Bluthgeld's imagined second war begins, like the first, with blasts in orbit (XII): the paranoid's first target is the commons overhead.

The orbital commons remains as fragile as the novel imagined. Donald Kessler's 1978 model of a self-sustaining debris cascade, and the debris clouds left by anti-satellite tests since, demonstrate that a single act of violence in orbit can deny the common sky to all. The novel understood in 1963 that the voice binding the survivors depends on an orbit that one man's violence can foreclose.

4.10 Voices in the Sky: From Dangerfield to VALIS

Nevil Shute's *On the Beach* (1957) supplies the decisive counter-image. A Morse signal from near Seattle raises hope of survivors, and a submarine crosses the dead Pacific to find a Coca-Cola bottle caught in a window blind, swinging in the wind against a transmitter key. The voice from elsewhere is noise, and the world an empty channel. Dangerfield is its antithesis: the voice from elsewhere is a person. Emily St. John Mandel's *Station Eleven* (2014), whose Traveling Symphony carries Shakespeare and music through a ruined continent under the motto that survival is insufficient, belongs to the same lineage: Dangerfield is a one-man symphony in orbit.

Nathanael West's *Miss Lonelyhearts* (1933) supplies the darker precedent: a newspaper advice columnist who becomes confessor to the city's suffering, takes its letters into himself, and breaks under them. Dangerfield's illness, which Hoppy's emanations aggravate but which Stockstill also suspects of hypochondria (XIV), belongs to the same type, the sickness of the one who must hear everyone. The novel's answer to West is institutional: the confessor is given a confessor, and the cure is broadcast (XVI).

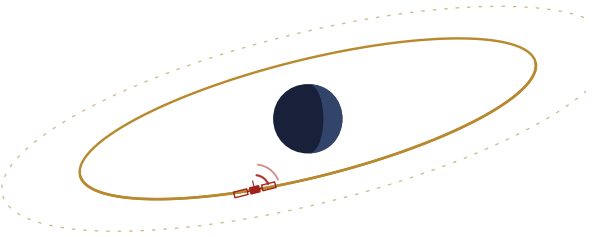
Dick's subsequent fiction unfolds the figure's possibilities. In *The Penultimate Truth* (1964), survivors living in underground tanks are governed by broadcasts from a simulated leader maintained by an elite that has secretly reclaimed the surface: Hoppy's project realized as a regime. In *Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep?* (1968), the ubiquitous broadcaster Buster Friendly is himself an android, and he exposes the empathic religion of Mercerism as a staged fraud. In *Ubik* (1969), the dead in half-life receive the messages of the living through the walls of their decaying world. In *VALIS* (1981), the divine is figured as an orbiting satellite that fires information into human minds. The genealogy runs from the human voice in the sky, to the simulated voice, to the divine. It matters that its origin is human: fallible, comic, ill, and in need of help.

The broadcaster's first name completes the figure. Walt Whitman wrote "I Hear America Singing" (1860) and declared "I am large, I contain multitudes" (*Song of Myself*,

§51). The democratic bard contains the multitude by hearing it. Walt Dangerfield contains multitudes by relaying their requests; Hoppy contains them by imitation, which is the counterfeit of Whitman's democratic capacity. The distinction between hearing a multitude and impersonating one is the distinction on which the novel's politics turns.

CHAPTER FIVE

5



The Crypt and the Bardo

Bill Keller and the Metempsychotic Settlement

> *The mimic is terrified of the mimic of the dead.*

5.1 The Child of the Instant

Bill and Edie Keller were conceived on the day the world ended. In the hour after the strike, Bonny Keller coupled with Andrew Gill, a tobacconist she did not know, and Gill, finding her shoes on the seat of his car, abandoned his former life to remain near her (VI). The twins are children of the Emergency itself, Eros at the instant of Thanatos. Seven years later Edie insists that she has a brother, and West Marin assumes an imaginary companion. Examining her, Dr. Stockstill finds the brother growing inside her like a cyst, decides not to tell her parents that the growth is conscious, and wonders who her father is (IX).

Bill's perceptual situation inverts the human one. He depends on his sister for nourishment and for her reports of a world he cannot see or hear; independently, he sees and converses with the dead (X). He is blind among the living and sighted among the dead. Edie narrates the world to him (IX), and the twins' relation is the oldest relation of literature: a voice making a world for one who cannot otherwise reach it. He wants to be born; she tells him he could not survive (X).

The condition has a clinical name, *fetus in fetu*, a rare anomaly in which a malformed twin is enclosed within the body of its sibling. Dick converts the pathology into a mode of consciousness and the mode into a theology. The encrypted twin is the novel's least powerful being and, at the end, its most consequential.

5.2 The Dead Twin: Jane Charlotte Dick

Philip Kindred Dick was born six weeks premature in Chicago on 16 December 1928, with a twin sister, Jane Charlotte, who died on 26 January 1929. He came to hold his

mother's care responsible, and his biographers concur that the loss became a founding wound of his imagination (Sutin 1989; Carrère 1993; Arnold 2016). Throughout his life he reported a sense of her presence. The headstone in Fort Morgan, Colorado, under which she was buried bore his name beside hers, his death date left blank, for more than half a century; in 1982 his ashes were buried there.

The novel inverts the configuration while preserving its structure. In Dick's life the sister died and the brother lived; in the novel the sister lives in the world and the brother lives inside her, in commerce with the dead. The twin who in history was lost is in the fiction encrypted: alive, hidden, carried, and conversant with the dead on the survivor's behalf. Bill is not Jane, and the novel is not a symptom. But the figure of a twin who speaks from the place of the dead is Dick's lifelong fantasy given a body, and the climax, in which the encrypted twin is born into the world, is the most audacious wish-fulfillment in the oeuvre.

5.3 Crypt and Phantom: Abraham and Torok

Nicolas Abraham and Maria Torok distinguished two responses to loss. Introjection, the work of mourning, enlarges the ego to include what has been lost. Incorporation, its refusal, swallows the lost object whole and keeps it alive inside the ego in a sealed space they called the crypt, where it persists as a living dead whose presence speaks only through cryptonyms, words that hide other words (Abraham and Torok 1978). Their later notion of the phantom names a transgenerational haunting: a parent's unspeakable secret lodged in a child's unconscious, where it speaks as a foreign voice. Derrida's preface to their study of the Wolf Man described the crypt as a forum inside the self, an outside within (Derrida 1976).

Bill is the crypt literalized: a sibling incorporated, kept alive inside the body of the other, speaking with the voices of the dead. Edie is the cryptophore, the crypt's bearer, and she loves the guest she carries. Bill is also a channel of phantoms in Abraham and Torok's sense. What he knows is the community's unspoken knowledge: that Hoppy has killed and will kill again, and that the new schoolteacher is sleeping with their mother (XII). Above all, the twins embody the secret around which the Keller household is organized, their own paternity, the mother's coupling with a stranger at the hour of the bomb. They are the phantom of Bonny's unspoken act, given flesh.

The climax is a decryption. Hoppy, hearing the twins approach his house, forcibly extracts Bill from his sister's body, intending that he perish in the open air (XV). The crypt is breached, and its occupant enters the world. Psychoanalytic theory has no category for what follows: an incorporated object that is neither mourned nor dies, but is delivered. The novel's category is metempsychosis.

The extraction is also a massacre of the innocents in miniature. Like Herod, the ruler who fears a birth, Hoppy forces the unborn into the open so that he will die there

(XV); and like the nativity it inverts, the attempt brings about exactly the birth it was meant to prevent.

5.4 The Uncanny Sibling: Rank and Freud

Otto Rank argued that the double originates as an insurance against death, the immortal soul's first image, and later reverses into death's harbinger (Rank 1914). Freud built on Rank in "The Uncanny," where the double's reversal from guarantor to omen exemplifies the return of the surmounted (Freud 1919). Bill is both. He is the assurance that the dead persist, since he converses with them, and to Hoppy he is the omen of death. Leaning close to Edie, Hoppy hears the voice of his dead employer and screams (X); afterwards he mistakes the living Stuart McConchie for another of Bill's impersonations (XI).

The mimic is terrified of the mimic of the dead. A hierarchy of mimesis governs the novel. To imitate the living is a skill; to speak as the dead is a power; and the second outranks the first because the dead cannot be ventriloquized without their consent. Bill speaks in Fergesson's voice as the dead man's emissary, not his counterfeit.

5.5 Homunculi: Paracelsus, Goethe, Miller

The alchemical homunculus, a tiny human generated outside the womb and knowing all arts by nature, entered the European imagination through the treatise *De natura rerum* attributed to Paracelsus (1537). Goethe's *Faust II* (1832) gave it a soul. Wagner's Homunculus, all intellect and light in its glass phial, longs to come into being in the full sense, to acquire a body. The philosophers advise it to begin in the sea and rise through the forms of life, and it ends by shattering its glass against the shell-chariot of Galatea, dissolving into the sea in an act of eros.

Bill's longing to be born is the Homunculus's longing, and his experiments follow Goethe's prescription with comic literalism. He wishes to pass into a snail (XII); he passes into a worm and can neither see nor hear, only crawl (XIII); and he is swallowed by an owl (XV). He climbs the ladder of forms toward a human birth.

Ernst Bloch's ontology of the Not-Yet (*Noch-Nicht*), which reads the world as matter still carrying unrealized possibility, names Bill's mode of being more exactly than any psychology (Bloch 1954–59). He is the novel's Not-Yet-Born, and his hope, unlike Hoppy's ressentiment, is directed at a world he has never seen.

Walter M. Miller's *A Canticle for Leibowitz* (1959) supplies Bill's structural twin in the American post-nuclear canon. Mrs. Grales, a two-headed seller of tomatoes, carries a dormant second head named Rachel. In the second Flame Deluge Rachel awakens, apparently free of original sin, and administers the sacrament to the dying abbot. In both novels a second consciousness, sleeping in another's body, is awakened by catastrophe into a preternatural innocence. The difference is temporal. Miller's innocent arrives at

the end of history as the sign of a new creation; Dick's arrives in the middle of things, as a child who wants to see the world.

Dick's later fiction repeats the figure. In *Martian Time-Slip* (1964), Manfred Steiner's perception of time is invaded by decay and death; in *A Scanner Darkly* (1977), two consciousnesses compete within one damaged brain; in *The Divine Invasion* (1981), the child-god Emmanuel speaks to his mother from the womb. Bill is the hinge between Manfred and Emmanuel, between the child whose access to death is a curse and the child whose enclosure is divine.

5.6 The Bardo and the Womb Door

The *Bardo Thödol* describes three intermediate states: the *chikhai bardo* at the moment of death, when the clear light dawns; the *chönyid bardo*, in which the peaceful and wrathful deities appear; and the *sidpa bardo*, the state of becoming, in which consciousness is drawn toward rebirth (Evans-Wentz 1927). Its counsel for the last state is to close the door of the womb if possible and, if rebirth cannot be avoided, to choose the womb wisely, preferring a human birth. Jung's commentary proposed reading the book in reverse, as an account of the psyche's descent from consciousness toward its depths (Jung 1935).

Bill lives in a *bardo* in the literal sense of the word, an in-between: neither born nor dead, conscious without a world, conversant with the dead and dependent on the living. West Marin is itself an intermediate state, since the novel equates the post-war world with the realm beyond the grave (III, VI). Bill's passage through snail, worm, and owl is a *sidpa bardo* in miniature, a consciousness passing through animal wombs in search of a human birth.

His final choice, after Hoppy's murder of the physicist forecloses the planned transfer into Jack Tree (XIII), is the phocomelus body. It is the choice of a womb door. The Buddhist doctrine of the precious human birth holds that a human existence is rare and valuable because it alone permits liberation. Bill accepts a human body however unlike the norm, and the novel quietly affirms the doctrine against its culture's revulsion from the phocomelus.

Hoppy's end completes the inversion. Thrust into the discarded fetal body, his consciousness expires shortly afterwards, and Stockstill finds the cyst dead (XVI). In 1981 Hoppy had entered a trance and believed he saw beyond the grave, when he had in fact seen the future. In 1988 the man who mistook the future for the afterlife is delivered to the afterlife in earnest.

5.7 Nekyia: The Blood Price of the Voices of the Dead

The second working title, *A Terran Odyssey*, summons the eleventh book of the *Odyssey*. At the edge of the world Odysseus digs a pit, pours libations, and cuts the throats of

sheep, and the shades crowd to the dark blood. Only those who drink can speak and recognize him; his own mother does not know him until she has drunk. In Homer, blood is the price of the voices of the dead.

The novel's two titles converge in this scene: blood money buys the speech of the dead. And the novel divides the Homeric economy between its antagonists. Hoppy pays for voice in blood throughout. He breaks Eldon Blaine's neck over a radio transmitter (X), kills Bluthgeld to clear his way, and weakens Dangerfield in order to take his voice; his career is the purchase of voice with blood. Bill receives the voices of the dead without blood. They come to him freely and warn him, unpaid, of Hoppy's danger. The novel thus opposes two economies of voice, the sacrificial and the gratuitous. Phonic justice, as Chapter Seven formalizes it, is the abolition of the blood price of voice.

The ethics of speaking for the dead has its gravest modern statement in Primo Levi's last book, which argues that the survivors of the Nazi camps are not the true witnesses: those who saw the worst did not return, and the survivors speak in their place, by proxy (Levi 1986). Giorgio Agamben made that gap the structure of testimony itself, in which the witness speaks for one who cannot (Agamben 1998). The novel's acoustic ethics stands inside that structure. Bill is a proxy who lets the dead speak and claims no authority of his own; Hoppy is a false witness who borrows the voices of the absent in order to command the living. Mediumship and ventriloquism are the two answers to Levi's problem, and the novel judges between them.

5.8 Pythagoras' Puppy and the Choice of Odysseus

The oldest Western testimony to the transmigration of souls is an act of listening. Xenophanes reports that Pythagoras, passing a puppy being beaten, bade the man stop, for it was the soul of a friend, recognized by its cry (DK 21 B7). The post-war world of the novel is Pythagorean: a sheepdog imitates human speech, cats are rumored to have languages of their own, and a child's consciousness migrates through snail, worm, owl, and man. Voice is the index of soul, and justice toward souls begins with hearing them in whatever body they cry from.

Plato's myth of Er completes the frame. Souls choose their next lives from lots laid before them: Orpheus chooses a swan, Ajax a lion, Agamemnon an eagle. Odysseus, choosing last and cured of ambition by the memory of his labors, searches long for the life of a private man who minds his own affairs, finds it lying neglected, and takes it gladly (*Republic* 620c–d). The lesson of Er is to choose by understanding rather than appetite. Bill chooses the life no one wanted, a limbless body on a cart in a coastal village; Hoppy had chosen sovereignty. The *Terran Odyssey* ends with the choice of Odysseus.

5.9 Medium and Media: Kittler, Sconce, Serres

Friedrich Kittler argued that the realm of the dead extends as far as the storage and transmission capacities of a culture, and that spiritualism and phonography grew up together (Kittler 1986). Jeffrey Sconce traced the haunting of electronic media, from early radio's "etheric ocean" to Friedrich Jürgenson's tape recordings of 1959 and Konstantīns Raudive's claims to have recorded the voices of the dead (Sconce 2000). The novel's ontology of the dead is media-theoretical. The dead persist as signal, and Bill is their receiver. Dangerfield's recordings are stored voices of the dead, Bach and a Yiddish song from 1932. Hoppy is a transmitter of counterfeit voices.

Mediumship and media manipulation both concern the voices of the absent. The moral difference between them is the difference between letting the absent speak and speaking as the absent.

Michel Serres's *Le Parasite* (1980) turns on a French word that names three things at once: the organism that lives off a host, the guest who eats at another's table without returning the meal, and static, the noise in a channel. The host (*hôte*) is also the guest. The novel is a parasitology in all three senses. Bill is a biological parasite whom his host loves and narrates to, more guest than parasite. Hoppy is the informational parasite, the noise that jams and counterfeits the signal. The climax is a parasite expelling a parasite: the guest who could not be born displaces the noise that would not stop.

Serres's thesis that every system requires a third, an interrupter whose interference generates new order, describes West Marin precisely. It is not a pure community but a parasitic commons, built from guests, static, and interruptions, whose order emerges, in Heinz von Foerster's phrase, from noise (von Foerster 1960).

5.10 Keller, Cellar, Lucy: A Philology of Enclosure

The twins' surname is German for cellar. On the day of the strike the repairmen are sent to a basement and Stuart survives in one (V–VI); seven years later Bill lives in the cellar of his sister's body, the fallout shelter of the flesh. The pun had a public referent. In July 1961, during the Berlin crisis, President Kennedy asked Americans on national television to provide fallout shelters for their families (Kennedy 1961), and the family shelter in the basement became a fixture of the early 1960s. The name also summons Helen Keller, the deafblind child whose enclosure broke at a water pump when her teacher spelled "water" into her palm and she grasped that everything has a name (Keller 1903). Bill's condition radicalizes hers. Without sight or hearing of the living, he receives the world through his sister's narration, and his entry into Hoppy's body is a breakthrough into perception. His first act once embodied is to go looking for Edie (XVI): the newly sighted twin seeks the sister who narrated the world to him.

The owl that swallows Bill (XV) is overdetermined. It is the bird of Minerva, whose flight at dusk Hegel made the emblem of philosophy's belatedness (Hegel 1820), and in

many traditions a psychopomp, a messenger between the living and the dead. Bill takes control of the bird, makes it fly back, and has it disgorge him (XVI). Swallowed and disgorged, he is a Jonah: "the LORD spake unto the fish, and it vomited out Jonah upon the dry land" (Jonah 2:10), and like Jonah he is returned to a city under judgment. The owl of belated wisdom becomes the vehicle of timely intervention.

The worm completes the philology. When Bill passes into a worm, he can neither see nor hear, only crawl (XIII). That is the condition of Wordsworth's Lucy, who "neither hears nor sees," rolled round with rocks and stones and trees. The twin tries on the condition of the buried girl of the working title and returns from it. Where Lucy is absorbed into the earth's diurnal course, Bill passes through it and out again.

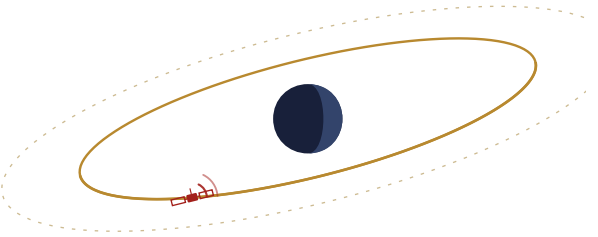
5.11 The Metempsychotic Settlement and Its Aporia

The exchange of bodies closes the wergild ledger without payment. The creditor's body passes to the innocent; the creditor's consciousness dies in the innocent's discarded flesh; no debt is discharged, but the relation of debt is dissolved. Chapter One called this a chiasmus, and Chapter Three showed its ethical form: disability affirmed, ressentiment expelled.

The settlement is nonetheless aporetic. Derrida argued that a gift recognized as a gift is annulled into exchange (Derrida 1991), and Bill's gift to the world is an exchange that kills. It is also, strictly, self-defense, since Hoppy initiated the expulsion hoping Bill would perish (XV). But the novel's justice remains a killing narrated as a birth, carried out without trial by a being who has never seen a face. For Emmanuel Levinas the face of the other is the first prohibition, an appeal that forbids killing before it says anything else (Levinas 1961). Bill, who has known others only as voices of the dead and through his sister's narration, kills before he has faced anyone. The novel's integrity lies in its refusal to hide the price. Stockstill examines the expired cyst (XVI). The doctor's examination of that small dead body is the novel's acknowledgment that its deliverance, like its catastrophe, leaves a corpse.

CHAPTER SIX

6



The Diurnal Commons

Bricolage, Homeostasis, and the Ethics of Getting Along

> *Happiness, here, is a rhythm rather than an outcome.*

6.1 The Polity of West Marin

By 1988 the United States survives as a military government in Cheyenne, while California is governed by local councils that regard one another with varying hostility. Oil is scarce, cars are drawn by horses or fitted with wood-burning engines, and ranchland has been ploughed for corn. West Marin governs itself through a council. June Raub, who relishes the chance the war has given her to prove her worth, presides in the Foresters' Hall; Orion Stroud chairs the school board; George Keller runs the school; Dr. Stockstill has become a general practitioner; Andrew Gill runs a factory; and Paul Dietz edits a newspaper that knows what it cannot print (VII–XI). These are the institutions Tocqueville found in the American township: associations, a school board, a newspaper, a hall. Catastrophe has not abolished American civil society; it has shrunk it back to the scale at which it was first described.

Sherwood Anderson's *Winesburg, Ohio* (1919) supplies the American model for such a town. In its prologue, people become grotesques the moment they seize a single truth and try to live by it. West Marin is a Winesburg after the bomb: Bluthgeld has seized the truth of his guilt and Hoppy the truth of his injury, each is made grotesque by it, and the commons survives by declining to let any single truth govern.

The polity is anchored in a precise geology. Point Reyes Station lies at the head of Tomales Bay, which fills the trough of the San Andreas fault; the peninsula to the west rides the Pacific plate, and near Olema the earthquake of 1906 offset fences and roads by as much as twenty feet. Dick, who lived there from 1958 to 1964, set his commons on land that is literally migrating away from the continent: a fragment of another plate, an island in all but water, and, as Chapter Three observed, a Prospero's isle.

6.2 Westward the Course of Empire

George Berkeley's "Verses on the Prospect of Planting Arts and Learning in America" (written 1726; published 1752) ends with a prophecy:

> *Westward the course of empire takes its way;*
> *The first four acts already past,*
> *A fifth shall close the drama with the day:*
> *Time's noblest offspring is the last.*

In 1866 a trustee of the College of California recalled the stanza and proposed the bishop's name for the new college town. The novel begins in the city named for that prophecy and moves west to the edge of the continent, where the course of empire runs out at the Pacific. Its catastrophe closes the American drama "with the day," which is to say diurnally, and its last-born, the twin conceived on the old world's final day, is in Berkeley's phrase time's last offspring. After the fifth act, the novel proposes, comes not a sixth but a daily one.

Berkeley's immaterialism is equally pertinent. If to be is to be perceived, the unperceived persists only because God perceives it. The novel's ontology of perception is Berkeleian with a technological substitution. Bill longs to perceive; Bluthgeld dreads being perceived; and the being that holds the dispersed survivors in common existence is a perceiver passing overhead, a disc jockey who sees the whole earth and speaks to it. The novel also ends in Berkeley, where Bonny, Gill, Stuart, and the Hardys plan their enterprise (XV–XVI). The narrative returns to its point of departure, and its plot traces an orbit.

6.3 Bricolage and the Reliquary Economy: Lévi-Strauss, Jameson, Benjamin

Claude Lévi-Strauss distinguished the engineer, who designs tools and materials for a project, from the bricoleur, who works with whatever is at hand, a finite and heterogeneous stock of remnants, each already used and already signifying (Lévi-Strauss 1962). Bluthgeld was the engineer of the old world. The after-world belongs to bricoleurs: Hoppy, the repairman; Dean Hardy, a radio engineer turned trap-maker; Stuart, who sells traps built from missile parts and talks with Hardy of selling pin-up calendars, sewing needles, and mutant crops (IX); Gill, who makes tobacco and brandy from what grows; Eldon Blaine, who trades eyeglasses for antibiotics. Bricolage is the survivor's epistemology.

Jameson read the after-world as a Utopian space in which small business, handicraft, and repair can be imagined again, and the ending warrants him: the novel closes on a business plan (XVI). Walter Benjamin offers a complementary reading that does

not cancel his. The post-war economy is a reliquary economy, in which the objects of the old world (records, books, eyeglasses, missile parts, pre-war cigarettes) circulate as remains, valuable because they survived. Benjamin discerned revolutionary energy in the outmoded (Benjamin 1929) and a redeemer of things in the collector (Benjamin 1931). The after-world is a world of collectors and repairers, in which things enjoy an afterlife. Its nostalgia, which Jameson read as petty-bourgeois, is also redemptive: the outmoded rescued from oblivion and put back to use.

6.4 Homeostasis and Its Devils: Cannon, Wiener, Ashby, Bateson, von Foerster

Walter Cannon named homeostasis, the body's maintenance of internal equilibrium (Cannon 1932). Norbert Wiener founded cybernetics on feedback (Wiener 1948). W. Ross Ashby built a homeostat that recovered equilibrium by reconfiguring itself at random until it found a stable state (Ashby 1952). Gregory Bateson described schismogenesis, the escalating differentiation between groups, in a symmetrical form, rivalry answered by rivalry as in an arms race, and a complementary form, dominance answered by submission (Bateson 1936). Two decades later he and his colleagues proposed the double bind, contradictory injunctions issued at different logical levels with no exit, as a matrix of schizophrenia (Bateson et al. 1956). Heinz von Foerster added that self-organizing systems feed on noise (von Foerster 1960).

The novel's community is a homeostatic system recovering from a catastrophic perturbation. Dangerfield is its negative feedback: humor, weather, news, and practical tips dampen panic and sustain routine. Bluthgeld and Hoppy are positive-feedback loops. Bluthgeld's relapse is symmetrical schismogenesis carried into a single psyche, each sighting of an enemy confirming the enmity. Hoppy's relation to the community is complementary schismogenesis: each act of deference feeds the next act of domination, and the council's reward deepens his contempt (XIV). His pre-war condition was a double bind in Bateson's precise sense. A principled shopkeeper employed him as an equal while everyone else treated him as an object of charity: an injunction to be normal issued in a frame that denied him normality.

Wiener's most suggestive distinction concerns two devils (Wiener 1950). The Augustinian devil is nature's disorder, which resists but does not cheat; the Manichaean devil is an adversary who changes strategy in order to deceive. Paranoia is the conversion of the Augustinian devil into the Manichaean: the reading of indifferent chance as intelligent malice. Bluthgeld reads every stare, every blemish, every chance reappearance as a move in a game against him. Hoppy is a genuine Manichaean devil, adaptive and deceptive, a counterfeiter of signals, and Hardy's traps against intelligent vermin are the Manichaean contest in miniature. The ethic of getting along is Au-

gustinian. It accepts that most of what befalls us is not aimed at us, and reserves Manichaean vigilance for the few who really do cheat.

6.5 Decency: Camus and the Doctor

Albert Camus's *La Peste* (1947) is narrated by a doctor, Bernard Rieux, who refuses heroism and holds that the only means of fighting a plague is decency, which he defines as doing one's job. Camus had written in *Combat* on 8 August 1945 that with Hiroshima mechanized civilization had reached its last degree of savagery, and in "Neither Victims nor Executioners" (1946) he sought an ethics for those who would be neither. Stockstill is Rieux in West Marin. The psychiatrist turned general practitioner does his job: he treats Bluthgeld, examines Edie, keeps her secret, and attempts to treat Dangerfield. His last act is a talking cure that Dangerfield, in good spirits, mockingly broadcasts to the world (XVI). Camusian decency meets Spinozist joy, and the private session becomes public property: the *idios kosmos* of therapy is absorbed into the *koinos kosmos* of the airwaves.

Camus's *Le Mythe de Sisyphe* (1942) asked that we imagine Sisyphus happy. The diurnal commons is a Sisyphean community made convivial: evenings at the hall, the satellite's passes, trap sales and repairs, all repeated without promise of completion. Happiness, here, is a rhythm rather than an outcome.

6.6 Can One Go On Living? Adorno, Kahn, Lifton

Adorno wrote that to write a poem after Auschwitz is barbaric (Adorno 1951a), that wrong life cannot be lived rightly (Adorno 1951b), and later that the real question was whether one who had escaped by accident may go on living at all (Adorno 1966). Kahn's question, whether the survivors would envy the dead, is the strategist's version of Adorno's. Dick's subtitle answers both: one gets along. The phrase claims neither reconciliation nor right living. It names a modus vivendi, the minimal ethical form of continued life in a damaged world. Adorno would suspect the novel's comedy of false reconciliation. The novel's reply is that its comedy is bricolage, not reconciliation: the use of remnants for living, without the claim that living has thereby been redeemed.

Robert Jay Lifton's study of the survivors of Hiroshima described the death imprint, survivor guilt, psychic numbing, and the need for formulation, the reconstruction of meaning without which survival cannot be lived (Lifton 1967). The novel, written four years before his study appeared, anticipates its typology. Bluthgeld is guilt without formulation; Hoppy is numbing converted into power; and the community's ritual listening is its formulation, a meaning reconstructed not as doctrine but as a schedule.

6.7 A Typology of Settlements

The post-catastrophe novel can be sorted by the settlement it reaches with catastrophe, the temporal figure that governs its narrative, and what it allows to survive. Table 2 proposes six types, the last of which is Dick's.

TABLE 2

Six settlements of the post-catastrophe novel

SETTLEMENT	EXEMPLARS	TEMPORAL FIGURE	WHAT SURVIVES
Extinction	Shute, *On the Beach* (1957); Roshwald, *Level 7* (1959)	The terminal point	Nothing; a signal without a sender
Restoration	Frank, *Alas, Babylon* (1959)	The frontier reset	The patriarchal household and its competences
Cycle	Miller, *A Canticle for Leibowitz* (1959)	The wheel of rise and fall	An archive, preserved and doomed to recur
Entropy	Stewart, *Earth Abides* (1949); Hoban, *Riddley Walker* (1980); McCarthy, *The Road* (2006)	The long decline	Myth, dialect, a father and a son
Aesthetic survival	Mandel, *Station Eleven* (2014)	The tour	Art as what makes survival sufficient
Diurnal recurrence	Dick, *Dr. Bloodmoney* (1965)	The orbit	A common voice heard daily; an economy of remnants

George R. Stewart's *Earth Abides* is the closest regional comparison. Its hero, Ish, is a Berkeley graduate student who survives a pandemic and becomes patriarch of a Bay Area tribe whose totem is his hammer, and its title comes from Ecclesiastes: "One generation passeth away, and another generation cometh: but the earth abideth for ever" (Eccles. 1:4). *Earth Abides* and *In Earth's Diurnal Course* are two Bay Area titles that set the earth's persistence above human history. But Stewart's arc is entropic, a culture dwindling toward the tribal, while Dick's is metabolic, a culture recurring.

Pat Frank's *Alas, Babylon* celebrates a Florida household restored to frontier competence under the ideology of civil defense. Dick's commons is not a frontier of masculine competence but a bricolage of oddities, led as much by Bonny and June Raub as by any man. Miller's *Canticle* sets the preservation of learning within a cycle in which the flame deluge recurs, and Dick declines the grand cycle for the daily round. Russell Hoban's *Riddley Walker* remembers the splitting of the atom, two millennia on, as the myth of Eusa, who split the "Littl Shynin Man"; there catastrophe has become liturgy, while in Dick it is still news. Cormac McCarthy's father and son carry the fire through

a world without community. Gill's cigarettes are its profane counterpart: fire carried as pleasure rather than as moral flame, shared rather than guarded.

The restoration type has darker and stranger variants. Ward Moore's "Lot" (1953) pushes the frontier fantasy into survivalist patriarchy; Judith Merril's *Shadow on the Hearth* (1950) relocates survival to a mother's household; and Leigh Brackett's *The Long Tomorrow* (1955) imagines restoration as the legal prohibition of cities. Dick's commons answers all three. It is neither a patriarch's camp, nor a sealed home, nor a law against technology, but a town that repairs what it has.

Three further comparisons complete the constellation. Kim Stanley Robinson's *The Wild Shore* (1984), the first novel of Dick's most important critic, sets a post-war Californian valley, quarantined by the victors, around an old storyteller and a young narrator, in visible conversation with *Dr. Bloodmoney*. The Strugatskys' *Roadside Picnic* (1972) marks a stalker's daughter with the visitation, so that she slowly ceases to be human; Edie and Bill invert her, marked by catastrophe as by a gift. And J. G. Ballard's *The Drowned World* (1962) imagines catastrophe as a psychic regression its hero embraces, whereas Dick's survivors refuse inner apocalypse for outer routine.

6.8 The Parliament of Speaking Things: Rancière and Latour

Aristotle held that humans alone possess *logos*, while animals have only *phōnē*, the voice that signals pleasure and pain (*Politics* I.2). Jacques Rancière made this distinction the stake of politics, which occurs when those whose speech was counted as noise claim to speak, contesting the distribution of the sensible that assigns places and voices (Rancière 1995; 2000). The post-war world of the novel redistributes the sensible on a scale no human revolution has attempted. Animals have begun to speak and have formed tribes of their own; the dead speak through Bill; a disabled man becomes the indispensable voice of technical knowledge; a satellite speaks to all. Catastrophe multiplies the speaking beings. Bruno Latour later proposed a parliament of things in which nonhumans would be represented (Latour 1991). West Marin is that parliament in its raw state.

In Rancière's terms, Hoppy's injustice is to re-concentrate *logos* in a single mouth and convert every other voice into the *phōnē* of his command. Bill's justice is to let the dead speak in their own voices; Dangerfield's is to relay the voices of the many. Sara Teasdale's "There Will Come Soft Rains" (1918), which Ray Bradbury set in an automated house after humanity's end (Bradbury 1950), imagined a nature serenely indifferent to human extinction. Dick imagines a nature that, after the bomb, begins to talk back.

Rachel Carson's *Silent Spring* (1962), published the year before Dick wrote, gave contamination its most influential American image: a fable of a town on which a white powder falls like snow, after which no birds sing. Its title made silence the sign of poisoned nature. Dick inverts the sign. His contaminated world is not silent but newly

vocal, and the measure of its injury is not the absence of song but the question of who may now speak (Carson 1962).

Plato's myth of Er sharpens the ethical point. Odysseus chooses the life of a private man, an *idiōtēs*, a word cognate with Heraclitus' *idios*. The novel distinguishes the two. The *idios kosmos* is the private world that consumes the common one, which is Bluthgeld's pathology. The private life is a modest existence lived within a common world, which is Stuart's, Gill's, and finally Bill's. Getting along is a private life sustained by a common voice.

6.9 The Wheel of Becoming: A Heuristic Mapping

The Wheel of Becoming (*bhavacakra*), painted at the entrances of Tibetan monasteries, is held in the jaws of Yama, lord of death. At its hub circle three animals, the pig of ignorance, the rooster of craving, and the snake of aversion; its rim is divided into six realms of rebirth; and outside it a Buddha points toward the moon. Mapped onto the novel as a heuristic rather than a source, the wheel distributes the cast with striking economy (Table 3).

TABLE 3

The cast on the Wheel of Becoming (heuristic)

REALM	RULING CONDITION	FIGURE IN THE NOVEL	NARRATIVE FATE
Gods (***devas***)	Pleasure, music, long life; at its close, signs of decay that foretell a fall	Dangerfield: heavenly, musical, aging, ill	Recovery through the counter-gift of therapy (XVI)
Demigods (***asuras***)	Envy of the gods and war upon them; the wish-fulfilling tree is rooted in their realm but fruits in the gods'	Hoppy: envious of the voice in the sky; kills "Tree"	Expelled into death (XVI)
Humans	Mixed pleasure and pain; the one realm from which liberation is possible	Stuart, Bonny, Gill, Stockstill, Edie, the council	Getting along
Animals	Ignorance and predation	Intelligent vermin, animal tribes, a dog that imitates speech	Rising toward speech; hunted with traps
Hungry ghosts (***pretas***)	Departed spirits dependent on offerings from the living	The dead whom Bill sees and hears	They speak, warn, and act through Bill
Hell-beings	Torments generated by aversion, fire among them	Bluthgeld: paranoid hatred and the fire he summons	Lifted into the air and dropped (XIII)

Three features of the mapping deserve comment. The *asuras* of Buddhist cosmology make war on the gods because the wish-fulfilling tree has its roots in the *asura* realm and its fruit in the heavens; Hoppy, envious of the heavenly voice, kills a man called Tree. The gods, for all their pleasures, suffer at the end of their long lives the signs of decay (withering garlands, soiled robes, sweat, odor, discomfort on their seats) that foretell their fall; Dangerfield's chest pain is the deva's sign. And the three poisons at the hub map onto the antagonists and their culture: Bluthgeld's aversion, Hoppy's craving, and the ignorance of a civilization that built the bomb.

The novel has no Buddha outside the wheel. Its nearest figure of the way out is the satellite itself, a moon made by human hands that circles above the wheel and carries a voice. Liberation, in this novel, is not escape from the round of becoming but a common hearing within it.

6.10 In Earth's Diurnal Course: Wordsworth's Diptych

Wordsworth's poem, written in 1799 and published in the second edition of *Lyrical Ballads* (1800), consists of two quatrains separated by a death:

> *A slumber did my spirit seal;*
> *I had no human fears:*
> *She seemed a thing that could not feel*
> *The touch of earthly years.*
>
> *No motion has she now, no force;*
> *She neither hears nor sees;*
> *Rolled round in earth's diurnal course,*
> *With rocks, and stones, and trees.*

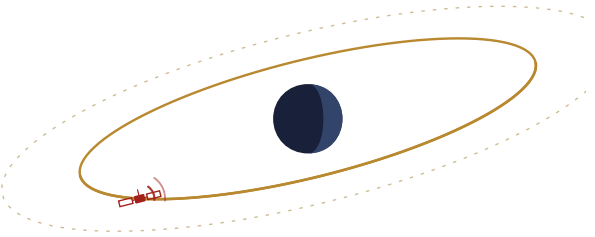
The poem's form is the novel's form. A before and an after are separated by an event the poem does not narrate: the death occurs in the white space between the stanzas. The first stanza is the pre-war world, a slumber that seals the spirit, "no human fears," an illusion of immunity to time: the sleepers of Heraclitus and the actuaries of Kahn. The second stanza is the after-world, motion and force gone, the dead absorbed into the planet's rotation. Dick took his title from the second stanza. The novel lives in the after.

Yet the novel revises the poem at the decisive point. Wordsworth's speaker contemplates a dead girl absorbed into a cosmos indifferent to her. Dick's survivors live within the diurnal course and hear in it a voice that is not indifferent. Dangerfield's capsule is itself rolled round in earth's diurnal course, but it speaks. The diurnal course of the novel is not the rotation of a corpse among stones but the passage of a voice among

the living. The paranoid named Tree sought the poem's oblivion; the community found its rhythm.

CHAPTER SEVEN

7



Orbital Eschatology

The Thesis Stated

> *The end is a circle rather than a point.*

7.1 From the Point to the Orbit

Christian eschatology inherited from Paul a punctual end: "In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trump" (1 Cor. 15:52). The bomb gave the punctual eschaton a technology. The flash over the New Mexico desert in July 1945 was an instant that could end a world, and Oppenheimer's later recollection that the test had called to mind the *Bhagavad Gita*'s theophany of the god as time, destroyer of worlds, sealed the identification of the weapon with the last day. The literature of the 1950s inherited the identification, and the extinction narratives of Table 2 are its purest form.

Frank Kermode's *The Sense of an Ending* (1967) diagnosed a shift in modern apocalyptic: the end had become immanent rather than imminent, a crisis felt to pervade the present rather than an event awaited in the future (Kermode 1967). *Dr. Bloodmoney* gives the immanent end a figure Kermode did not name. The end does not pervade the present as diffuse crisis; it passes through it as periodic return. It orbits. The capsule launched on the old world's last day circles the earth carrying the voice of a man who watched the end from above, and the communities below gather at the hour of its passing. The end becomes audible because it recurs.

Mircea Eliade argued that archaic societies regenerate time by periodically repeating the cosmogony, abolishing profane duration through ritual (Eliade 1949). The evening at the Foresters' Hall is such a ritual, a liturgy in the etymological sense of *leitourgia*, the work of the people, through which the after-world is founded again each day. The Stoics imagined a cosmos periodically consumed by fire (*ekpyrosis*) and reborn (*palingenesis*). Dick's version is neither cosmic nor periodic in the Stoic manner but local

and daily: the fire is domesticated as tobacco, and rebirth takes place in a single body on a single afternoon.

Jacques Derrida's "No Apocalypse, Not Now" argued that nuclear war is "fabulously textual," a non-event that exists only in discourse, because its referent would be the remainderless destruction of the archive (Derrida 1984). *Dr. Bloodmoney* is the counter-text: apocalypse with remainder. The archive survives in fragments (Maugham's novel, Bach, a Yiddish song, cigarettes, eyeglasses, missile parts), and the remainder is the substance of the after-world. Where Derrida theorizes an end that would erase the means of its own narration, Dick narrates an end that inaugurates an economy of remnants.

Every figure the preceding chapters assembled converges on the orbit: the *Dutchman IV*, condemned to circle until Judgment; the Pythagorean spheres that sound as they turn; Berkeley's drama closed "with the day"; Wordsworth's "earth's diurnal course"; a plot that returns from West Marin to Berkeley. The end is a circle rather than a point.

7.2 Five Propositions

THESIS I

The bomb is a hinge; the novel is a settlement.

The catastrophe is encountered as already survived (IV–V), and every subsequent plot concerns the reckoning it opened: who owes, who is owed, and what can be paid. The genre's question, as Kahn posed it, is not whether a world can end but what follows the end. The novel's structure, a prolepsis followed by a return to its city of origin, makes the following its form.

THESIS II

"Blood money" names the false currency of catastrophe.

Wergild, the *pretium sanguinis*, Nietzsche's *Schuld*, Augier's congenital bloodstain, and the cigarette currency of the after-world are forms of one attempt: to price an unpriceable injury. The novel's compensatory deixis, debtor and creditor, ends in murder; the community's payment to the killer is scorned as inadequate; and settlement by compensation proves self-defeating, because every payment leaves a creditor who wants more. The novel's ideological closure, as Chapter One argued, is the unthinkability of adequate reparation.

THESIS III

Voice is the true currency of the commons, and its norm is phonic justice.

Phonic justice is the equitable distribution, among the living, the dead, animals, and machines, of the capacity to speak in one's own voice and to be heard in common. The novel identifies three injustices against it: silencing, which is Bluthgeld's aim against the satellite; ventriloquism, Hoppy's counterfeit of the common voice; and the blood price of voice, the Homeric economy in which speech is bought with killing. It identifies four institutions that sustain it. The relay is Dangerfield's broadcast, which passes on the voices of others. The hall is co-audition, listening together at one hour. The medium is Bill's hospitality to the dead, which lets them speak in their own voices. The doctor is the talking cure made public. *Ventriloquial sovereignty*, phonic justice's antithesis, is the capture of a common voice by an injured exception who speaks as others.

THESIS IV

Justice after catastrophe is metempsychotic.

The novel settles injury not by payment but by re-tenancy: the re-inhabitation of injured forms by those who can inhabit them without ressentiment. Its paradigm is Bill's assumption of Hoppy's body, but the principle governs the whole after-world. Missile parts are re-tenanted as traps, a fraternal lodge as the people's hall, a novel of solitary reading as a story heard in common, a ghost ship as a broadcasting station, the murdered pacifist's classroom by a new teacher. Its cost is the eviction of the prior tenant, and the novel shows the corpse (XVI). Metempsychotic justice is neither retributive, since it inflicts no penalty proportioned to an offense, nor restorative, since it does not return things to their former state. It is transformative: a form survives by changing hands.

THESIS V

The eschaton orbits.

Orbital eschatology names the conversion of the end of the world from an event that terminates history into a recurrent passage that the survivors learn to hear. Its ethic is neither apocalyptic expectation, which waits for the end, nor actuarial denial, which prices it, but attention: to prepare each day for the voice's passing, to listen, and to answer. Its politics is the diurnal commons.

7.3 The Diurnal Commons as a Political Form

The diurnal commons is a distinct political form, intelligible against the classical alternatives. Hobbes's commonwealth is constituted by representation, the multitude made one person by a sovereign who bears its person. Schmitt's polity is constituted by decision on the exception. The contractarian polities of Locke and Rousseau are constituted by consent and the general will. The diurnal commons is constituted by co-audition, the act of listening together at the same hour. Its sovereign is no one: the voice belongs to a man who cannot land and claims no rule. Its law is a timetable of passes, its offices are relays, and its characteristic threat is the ventriloquist who would make the voice his own.

Jean-Luc Nancy argued that community is neither a work to be produced nor a fusion to be achieved but the exposure of finite beings to one another, revealed above all in the death of others; he called it the inoperative community, *la communauté désœuvrée* (Nancy 1986). West Marin is inoperative in Nancy's sense. It is not a project but a getting-along among mortals who have witnessed mass death. In *À l'écoute* Nancy described the listening subject as resonance, a self stretched toward a meaning not yet given (Nancy 2002). The commons of listeners is a community of resonance.

Henri Bergson distinguished closed societies, bound by obligation against outsiders, from the open society oriented toward humanity as such (Bergson 1932). West Marin is closed: an outsider who came hunting its hidden physicist is executed, and it fears Bolinas. Its openness is acoustic. It opens to a voice that addresses every settlement equally, so the broadcast is the novel's open society, a universality that arrives by radio rather than by doctrine.

Giorgio Agamben, reading Paul's "remnant according to the election of grace" (Rom. 11:5), described the remnant not as a part of the whole but as the division of divisions that prevents the whole from closing, the messianic subject that can never coincide with a people (Agamben 2000). The survivors are a remnant in this sense: they cannot be counted as a nation, and they get along. Benjamin's second thesis on history attributes to every generation a weak messianic power to which the past has a claim (Benjamin 1940). The redemption of *Dr. Bloodmoney* is weak in exactly that sense. It has no messiah, only a disc jockey, a doctor, a salesman, a tobacconist, and an unborn child.

The novel's restoration is partial in a theological sense as well. Origen taught *apokatastasis*, the final restoration of all things, in which even the devil would be saved, and Benjamin's "The Storyteller" traces the doctrine's survival in Leskov. *Dr. Bloodmoney* stops short of it. Its two antagonists are not restored but removed, one flung into the air and one expelled into a dying body, so its redemption is a remnant's, not a universe's.

7.4 The Orbits of the Oeuvre

Dick's oeuvre circles its own nuclei, and *Dr. Bloodmoney* holds four of them. The paranoid demiurge descends from Bluthgeld to Palmer Eldritch (1965), to Carleton Lufteufel, the war-maker worshipped in *Deus Irae* (1976), and to the Empire of *VALIS* (1981). The ventriloquial creditor is revised, through Tibor McMasters, into an artist-pilgrim, and displaced into the realm of the dead as Jory, the half-lifer of *Ubik* (1969) who sustains himself by consuming the lives of others. The voice in the sky passes from Dangerfield to the simulated leader of *The Penultimate Truth* (1964), to Buster Friendly (1968), and to the orbital theophany of *VALIS*. And the encrypted child runs from Manfred Steiner (1964) through Bill Keller to Emmanuel (1981). The oeuvre's eschatology is itself orbital: its figures return, altered each time, to the points they left.

7.5 Pertinence: The Age of Synthetic Voice

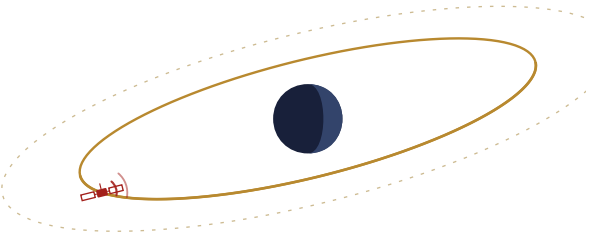
Hoppy's art, the perfect imitation of a beloved voice used to occupy a trusted channel, has become an industrial capability. Synthetic voice cloning now permits the fabrication of trusted voices for fraud and propaganda, and the scene in which a man hears his own voice on the air saying what he never said (XV) has become ordinary. The novel's normative distinction between mediumship and ventriloquism, between letting the absent speak and speaking as the absent, is therefore no longer a figure of speech. It is a criterion.

The criterion bears with particular force on the dead. Generative simulations of deceased persons, built from their recordings and writings, pose the question the novel poses through Bill and Hoppy: whether the dead are heard or impersonated. Phonic justice supplies a test. A technology of voice is just insofar as it relays rather than counterfeits, and insofar as those who hear it can tell the difference.

The orbital commons supplies a final pertinence. The sky is crowded with the relays on which the world's common voice depends, and the novel's warning, that one act of violence in orbit can silence the voice that binds survivors, has become a warning about infrastructure as a commons. The novel understood in 1963 that the condition of a common world is a common sky.

7.6 The Thesis in a Sentence

Dr. Bloodmoney, or How We Got Along After the Bomb converts the end of the world from a point into an orbit, and the settlement of catastrophe from compensation into hearing. It shows that blood money cannot pay for a world; that a voice freely given and freely heard can sustain one; and that justice after catastrophe consists in letting injured forms be re-inhabited, and the dead be heard rather than impersonated, each day, as the voice passes overhead.



How We Get Along

> *Rolled round in earth's diurnal course, the end has become a voice.*

The subtitle's past tense, *got along*, belongs to the survivors; the critic's tense is the present. The novel was written in 1963 under a sky in which the first active communications satellite had just been crippled by the radiation of high-altitude tests. It is read in a century whose common voice depends on relays in orbit and whose capacity to counterfeit voices has outrun its capacity to verify them. Its question has not changed: how do we get along after the end of a world? Its answer has only grown more exact. We get along by listening together, by repairing what is at hand, by letting injured forms be re-inhabited, and by refusing to let any single voice, however injured or however gifted, become the voice of all.

The dissertation has made seven contributions. It has read the commercial title as a hermeneutic key and reconstructed from it a wergild cosmos that integrates the novel's economic, juridical, and theological registers. It has proposed a semiotic square organized by obligation rather than production. It has defined phonic justice and ventriloquial sovereignty as the norm and the pathology of the post-catastrophe commons. It has named the novel's resolution a metempsychotic settlement and exposed its aporia. It has defined orbital eschatology as the novel's contribution to the theory of the end. It has brought disability theory and the psychoanalytic theory of the crypt to bear on a novel that demands both. And it has reconstructed the conjuncture of 1962–63, above all the near-simultaneous births of Starfish Prime and Telstar, as the novel's encrypted history.

The limits are equally clear. Cryptonymic readings are speculative by nature, and several proposed here (Tree, Keller, the *Dutchman IV*) remain hypotheses that a study of Dick's manuscripts and correspondence could confirm or disconfirm. The Wheel of Becoming is a heuristic, not a source. The use of Dick's biography is transferential and may still overreach.

Two dimensions of the novel deserve more than this study has given them. The first is its gender politics: Bonny Keller as erotic catalyst and civic leader, and Lydia Dangerfield's off-stage suicide, the Senta of a *Dutchman* she cannot redeem. The second is its racial imagination. Stuart McConchie, whom Dick named as his favorite character and the one with whom he most identified (Dick 1980), is a Black protagonist rare in the science fiction of 1963. The novel describes him in the vocabulary of its year, in which he is a Negro, and places him in a commons whose prejudices survive the bomb: he fears the racism of the countryside, and the local editor treats his meeting with Gill as unprintable. Jameson's reading, finally, has been re-situated rather than refuted. The novel does end on a business plan, and the economy of remnants is also an economy.

Three lines of further research follow. The first is genetic. *A Terran Odyssey*, the story Dick assembled from the novel in 1964 and saw published only posthumously in 1987, would show what he regarded as the novel's core. The second is comparative across the Pacific. Ibuse Masuji's *Kuroi ame* (*Black Rain*), serialized in 1965–66 as Dick's novel appeared, turns on the stigma of irradiation and on what is owed to those it marks; a comparison would test the wergild thesis against a literature written from within the aftermath of real bombs. The third is theoretical: the extension of phonic justice into a general theory of voice for an age of synthetic speech.

The last image is the one with which the novel's world begins each evening. At dusk the people of West Marin walk to the Foresters' Hall, the radio warms, and the voice of a man who saw the end of the world from above passes over the peninsula, reading a novel about human bondage, playing a Yiddish love song, taking requests. Rolled round in earth's diurnal course, the end has become a voice, and the survivors have become an audience that answers. To Herman Kahn's question the novel returns its answer: the survivors will not envy the dead, so long as they can hear them.

Works Cited

WORKS BY PHILIP K. DICK

Dick, Philip K. 1962. *The Man in the High Castle*. New York: Putnam.

Dick, Philip K. 1964a. *Martian Time-Slip*. New York: Ballantine.

Dick, Philip K. 1964b. *The Penultimate Truth*. New York: Belmont.

Dick, Philip K. 1965a. *Dr. Bloodmoney, or How We Got Along After the Bomb*. New York: Ace.

Dick, Philip K. 1965b. "Schizophrenia & The Book of Changes." Reprinted in Dick 1995.

Dick, Philip K. 1965c. *The Three Stigmata of Palmer Eldritch*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday.

Dick, Philip K. 1968. *Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep?* Garden City, NY: Doubleday.

Dick, Philip K. 1969. *Ubik*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday.

Dick, Philip K. 1977. *A Scanner Darkly*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday.

Dick, Philip K. 1980. Afterword to *Dr. Bloodmoney, or How We Got Along After the Bomb*, 299–304. New York: Dell.

Dick, Philip K. 1981a. *The Divine Invasion*. New York: Timescape.

Dick, Philip K. 1981b. *VALIS*. New York: Bantam.

Dick, Philip K. 1987. "A Terran Odyssey." In *The Collected Stories of Philip K. Dick*, vol. 5. Los Angeles: Underwood-Miller.

Dick, Philip K. 1995. *The Shifting Realities of Philip K. Dick: Selected Literary and Philosophical Writings*. Edited by Lawrence Sutin. New York: Pantheon.

Dick, Philip K. 2011. *The Exegesis of Philip K. Dick*. Edited by Pamela Jackson and Jonathan Lethem. Boston: Houghton Mifflin Harcourt.

Dick, Philip K., and Roger Zelazny. 1976. *Deus Irae*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday.

Lethem, Jonathan. 2008. "Notes on the Text." In Philip K. Dick, *Five Novels of the 1960s and 70s*. New York: Library of America.

BIOGRAPHY AND CRITICISM

Arnold, Kyle. 2016. *The Divine Madness of Philip K. Dick*. New York: Oxford University Press.

Carrère, Emmanuel. 1993. *Je suis vivant et vous êtes morts*. Paris: Seuil. Translated by Timothy Bent as *I Am Alive and You Are Dead*. New York: Metropolitan, 2004.

Jameson, Fredric. 1975. "After Armageddon: Character Systems in *Dr. Bloodmoney*." *Science Fiction Studies* 2, no. 1: 31–42.

Jameson, Fredric. 2005. *Archaeologies of the Future: The Desire Called Utopia and Other Science Fictions*. London: Verso.

Lem, Stanisław. 1975. "Philip K. Dick: A Visionary Among the Charlatans." Translated by Robert Abernathy. *Science Fiction Studies* 2, no. 1.

Mackey, Douglas A. 1988. *Philip K. Dick*. Boston: Twayne.

Palmer, Christopher. 2003. *Philip K. Dick: Exhilaration and Terror of the Postmodern*. Liverpool: Liverpool University Press.

Rickels, Laurence A. 2010. *I Think I Am: Philip K. Dick*. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press.

Robinson, Kim Stanley. 1984a. *The Novels of Philip K. Dick*. Ann Arbor: UMI Research Press.

Rossi, Umberto. 2009. "Acousmatic Presences: From DJs to Talk-Radio Hosts in American Fiction, Cinema, and Drama." *Mosaic* 42, no. 1: 83–98.

Rossi, Umberto. 2011. *The Twisted Worlds of Philip K. Dick: A Reading of Twenty Ontologically Uncertain Novels*. Jefferson, NC: McFarland.

Sutin, Lawrence. 1989. *Divine Invasions: A Life of Philip K. Dick*. New York: Harmony.

Suvin, Darko. 1975. "P. K. Dick's Opus: Artifice as Refuge and World View." *Science Fiction Studies* 2, no. 1.

Warrick, Patricia S. 1987. *Mind in Motion: The Fiction of Philip K. Dick*. Carbondale: Southern Illinois University Press.

PHILOSOPHY, THEORY, AND HISTORY

Abraham, Nicolas, and Maria Torok. 1976. *Cryptonymie: Le verbier de l'Homme aux loups*. With a preface by Jacques Derrida, "Fors." Paris: Aubier-Flammarion.

Abraham, Nicolas, and Maria Torok. 1978. *L'Écorce et le noyau*. Paris: Aubier-Flammarion. Translated by Nicholas T. Rand as *The Shell and the Kernel*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1994.

Adler, Alfred. 1907. *Studie über Minderwertigkeit von Organen*. Vienna: Urban & Schwarzenberg.

Adorno, Theodor W. 1951a. "Kulturkritik und Gesellschaft." In *Soziologische Forschung in unserer Zeit*, edited by Karl Gustav Specht. Cologne: Westdeutscher Verlag.

Adorno, Theodor W. 1951b. *Minima Moralia: Reflexionen aus dem beschädigten Leben*. Berlin and Frankfurt: Suhrkamp.

Adorno, Theodor W. 1966. *Negative Dialektik*. Frankfurt: Suhrkamp.

Agamben, Giorgio. 1995. *Homo sacer: Il potere sovrano e la nuda vita*. Turin: Einaudi.

Agamben, Giorgio. 1998. *Quel che resta di Auschwitz: L'archivio e il testimone*. Turin: Bollati Boringhieri.

Agamben, Giorgio. 2000. *Il tempo che resta: Un commento alla Lettera ai Romani*. Turin: Bollati Boringhieri.

Anders, Günther. 1956. *Die Antiquiertheit des Menschen*. Vol. 1. Munich: Beck.

Anders, Günther, and Claude Eatherly. 1961. *Burning Conscience*. Preface by Bertrand Russell. London: Weidenfeld & Nicolson.

Arendt, Hannah. 1958. *The Human Condition*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.

Arendt, Hannah. 1963. *Eichmann in Jerusalem: A Report on the Banality of Evil*. New York: Viking.

Aristotle. *Politics*.

Ashby, W. Ross. 1952. *Design for a Brain*. London: Chapman & Hall.

Bataille, Georges. 1947. "À propos de récits d'habitants d'Hiroshima." *Critique* 8–9.

Bataille, Georges. 1949. *La Part maudite*. Paris: Minuit.

Bateson, Gregory. 1936. *Naven*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Bateson, Gregory, Don D. Jackson, Jay Haley, and John Weakland. 1956. "Toward a Theory of Schizophrenia." *Behavioral Science* 1, no. 4: 251–64.

Benjamin, Walter. 1929. "Der Sürrealismus." *Die literarische Welt*.

Benjamin, Walter. 1931. "Ich packe meine Bibliothek aus." *Die literarische Welt*.

Benjamin, Walter. 1936. "Der Erzähler." *Orient und Occident*.

Benjamin, Walter. 1940. "Über den Begriff der Geschichte." Written 1940; first published 1942.

Benjamin, Walter. 2014. *Radio Benjamin*. Edited by Lecia Rosenthal. London: Verso.

Bergson, Henri. 1932. *Les Deux Sources de la morale et de la religion*. Paris: Alcan.

Berkeley, George. 1752. "Verses on the Prospect of Planting Arts and Learning in America." In *A Miscellany*. Dublin.

Bloch, Ernst. 1954–59. *Das Prinzip Hoffnung*. 3 vols. Berlin: Aufbau.

Boethius. *De institutione musica*.

Camus, Albert. 1942. *Le Mythe de Sisyphe*. Paris: Gallimard.

Camus, Albert. 1946. "Ni victimes ni bourreaux." *Combat*, November.

Camus, Albert. 1947. *La Peste*. Paris: Gallimard.

Canetti, Elias. 1960. *Masse und Macht*. Hamburg: Claassen. Translated by Carol Stewart as *Crowds and Power*. London: Gollancz, 1962.

Cannon, Walter B. 1932. *The Wisdom of the Body*. New York: Norton.

Carson, Rachel. 1962. *Silent Spring*. Boston: Houghton Mifflin.

Chion, Michel. 1982. *La Voix au cinéma*. Paris: Cahiers du cinéma.

Deleuze, Gilles. 1962. *Nietzsche et la philosophie*. Paris: Presses Universitaires de France.

Deleuze, Gilles. 1970. *Spinoza*. Paris: Presses Universitaires de France. Revised as *Spinoza: Philosophie pratique*. Paris: Minuit, 1981.

Derrida, Jacques. 1976. "Fors." Preface to Abraham and Torok 1976.

Derrida, Jacques. 1984. "No Apocalypse, Not Now (full speed ahead, seven missiles, seven missives)." *Diacritics* 14, no. 2: 20–31.

Derrida, Jacques. 1991. *Donner le temps*. Paris: Galilée.

Derrida, Jacques. 1993. *Spectres de Marx*. Paris: Galilée.

Diels, Hermann, and Walther Kranz, eds. 1951–52. *Die Fragmente der Vorsokratiker*. 6th ed. Berlin: Weidmann. Cited as DK.

Eliade, Mircea. 1949. *Le Mythe de l'éternel retour*. Paris: Gallimard.

European Court of Human Rights. 1979. *The Sunday Times v. the United Kingdom*. Application no. 6538/74. Judgment of 26 April 1979.

Evans-Wentz, W. Y., ed. 1927. *The Tibetan Book of the Dead*. London: Oxford University Press. Third edition, with C. G. Jung's psychological commentary, 1957.

Fiedler, Leslie. 1978. *Freaks: Myths and Images of the Secret Self*. New York: Simon & Schuster.

Freud, Sigmund. 1911. "Psychoanalytische Bemerkungen über einen autobiographisch beschriebenen Fall von Paranoia (Dementia paranoides)." *Standard Edition*, vol. 12.

Freud, Sigmund. 1916. "Einige Charaktertypen aus der psychoanalytischen Arbeit." *Standard Edition*, vol. 14.

Freud, Sigmund. 1919. "Das Unheimliche." *Standard Edition*, vol. 17.

Garland-Thomson, Rosemarie. 1997. *Extraordinary Bodies: Figuring Physical Disability in American Culture and Literature*. New York: Columbia University Press.

Girard, René. 1972. *La Violence et le sacré*. Paris: Grasset.

Harrington, James. 1656. *The Commonwealth of Oceana*. London.

Hegel, G. W. F. 1820. *Grundlinien der Philosophie des Rechts*. Berlin: Nicolai.

Heidegger, Martin. 1946. "Der Spruch des Anaximander." In *Holzwege*. Frankfurt: Klostermann, 1950.

Hobbes, Thomas. 1651. *Leviathan*. London: Andrew Crooke.

Hofstadter, Richard. 1964. "The Paranoid Style in American Politics." *Harper's Magazine*, November.

Jonas, Hans. 1958. *The Gnostic Religion*. Boston: Beacon.

Jung, C. G. 1935. "Psychologischer Kommentar zum Bardo Thödol." In *Das tibetanische Totenbuch*. Zurich: Rascher. English in Evans-Wentz, 3rd ed., 1957.

Jung, C. G. 1952. *Antwort auf Hiob*. Zurich: Rascher.

Jung, C. G. 1957. *Gegenwart und Zukunft*. Zurich: Rascher. Translated as *The Undiscovered Self*.

Kahn, Herman. 1960. *On Thermonuclear War*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.

Kantorowicz, Ernst H. 1957. *The King's Two Bodies: A Study in Mediaeval Political Theology*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.

Kennedy, John F. 1961. "Radio and Television Report to the American People on the Berlin Crisis." Broadcast 25 July 1961.

Kepler, Johannes. 1619. *Harmonices Mundi*. Linz.

Kermode, Frank. 1967. *The Sense of an Ending: Studies in the Theory of Fiction*. New York: Oxford University Press.

Kessler, Donald J., and Burton G. Cour-Palais. 1978. "Collision Frequency of Artificial Satellites: The Creation of a Debris Belt." *Journal of Geophysical Research* 83, no. A6: 2637–46.

Kittler, Friedrich. 1986. *Grammophon Film Typewriter*. Berlin: Brinkmann & Bose.

Lacan, Jacques. 1981. *Le Séminaire, livre III: Les psychoses (1955–1956)*. Paris: Seuil.

Latour, Bruno. 1991. *Nous n'avons jamais été modernes*. Paris: La Découverte.

Levi, Primo. 1986. *I sommersi e i salvati*. Turin: Einaudi.

Levinas, Emmanuel. 1961. *Totalité et infini*. The Hague: Martinus Nijhoff.

Lévi-Strauss, Claude. 1962. *La Pensée sauvage*. Paris: Plon.

Lifton, Robert Jay. 1967. *Death in Life: Survivors of Hiroshima*. New York: Random House.

Longmore, Paul K. 1985. "Screening Stereotypes: Images of Disabled People." *Social Policy* 16, no. 1.

Marx, Karl. 1867. *Das Kapital*. Vol. 1. Hamburg: Meissner. Translated by Samuel Moore and Edward Aveling as *Capital*, 1887.

Mauss, Marcel. 1924. "Gift, Gift." In *Mélanges offerts à Charles Andler*. Strasbourg: Istra.

Mauss, Marcel. 1925. "Essai sur le don." *L'Année sociologique*, n.s., 1.

May, Rollo, Ernest Angel, and Henri F. Ellenberger, eds. 1958. *Existence: A New Dimension in Psychiatry and Psychology*. New York: Basic Books.

McLuhan, Marshall. 1962. *The Gutenberg Galaxy*. Toronto: University of Toronto Press.

McLuhan, Marshall. 1964. *Understanding Media: The Extensions of Man*. New York: McGraw-Hill.

Merleau-Ponty, Maurice. 1945. *Phénoménologie de la perception*. Paris: Gallimard.

Mitchell, David T., and Sharon L. Snyder. 2000. *Narrative Prosthesis: Disability and the Dependencies of Discourse*. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press.

Nancy, Jean-Luc. 1986. *La Communauté désœuvrée*. Paris: Bourgois.

Nancy, Jean-Luc. 2002. *À l'écoute*. Paris: Galilée.

Nietzsche, Friedrich. 1873. *Die Philosophie im tragischen Zeitalter der Griechen*. Unpublished in the author's lifetime.

Nietzsche, Friedrich. 1883–85. *Also sprach Zarathustra*. Translated by Thomas Common as *Thus Spake Zarathustra*, 1909.

Nietzsche, Friedrich. 1887. *Zur Genealogie der Moral*. Leipzig: Naumann.

Ong, Walter J. 1982. *Orality and Literacy: The Technologizing of the Word*. London: Methuen.

Origen. *Peri archōn* (*De principiis*).

Paracelsus (attributed). 1537. *De natura rerum*.

Plato. *Republic*.

Radford, R. A. 1945. "The Economic Organisation of a P.O.W. Camp." *Economica* 12, no. 48: 189–201.

Rancière, Jacques. 1995. *La Mésentente: Politique et philosophie*. Paris: Galilée.

Rancière, Jacques. 2000. *Le Partage du sensible*. Paris: La Fabrique.

Rank, Otto. 1914. "Der Doppelgänger." *Imago* 3.

Sartre, Jean-Paul. 1960. *Critique de la raison dialectique*. Paris: Gallimard.

Scheler, Max. 1912. "Über Ressentiment und moralisches Werturteil." *Zeitschrift für Pathopsychologie* 1. Expanded as *Das Ressentiment im Aufbau der Moralen*, 1915.

Schmitt, Carl. 1922. *Politische Theologie*. Munich: Duncker & Humblot.

Sconce, Jeffrey. 2000. *Haunted Media: Electronic Presence from Telegraphy to Television*. Durham, NC: Duke University Press.

Serres, Michel. 1980. *Le Parasite*. Paris: Grasset.

Siebers, Tobin. 2004. "Disability as Masquerade." *Literature and Medicine* 23, no. 1: 1–22.

Siebers, Tobin. 2008. *Disability Theory*. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press.

Spinoza, Benedictus de. 1677. *Ethica ordine geometrico demonstrata*. In *Opera posthuma*. Amsterdam.

Sunday Times Insight Team. 1979. *Suffer the Children: The Story of Thalidomide*. London: André Deutsch.

Teilhard de Chardin, Pierre. 1955. *Le Phénomène humain*. Paris: Seuil. Translated as *The Phenomenon of Man*, 1959.

Todorov, Tzvetan. 1970. *Introduction à la littérature fantastique*. Paris: Seuil.

United States Atomic Energy Commission. 1954. *In the Matter of J. Robert Oppenheimer: Transcript of Hearing Before Personnel Security Board*. Washington, DC: Government Printing Office.

von Foerster, Heinz. 1960. "On Self-Organizing Systems and Their Environments." In *Self-Organizing Systems*, edited by Marshall C. Yovits and Scott Cameron. Oxford: Pergamon.

Wiener, Norbert. 1948. *Cybernetics, or Control and Communication in the Animal and the Machine*. Cambridge, MA: Technology Press.

Wiener, Norbert. 1950. *The Human Use of Human Beings*. Boston: Houghton Mifflin.

LITERARY AND CINEMATIC COMPARANDA

The Holy Bible. 1611. Authorized (King James) Version.

Anderson, Sherwood. 1919. *Winesburg, Ohio*. New York: B. W. Huebsch.

Ballard, J. G. 1962. *The Drowned World*. New York: Berkley.

Brackett, Leigh. 1955. *The Long Tomorrow*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday.

Bradbury, Ray. 1950. "There Will Come Soft Rains." In *The Martian Chronicles*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday.

Butler, Octavia E. 1993. *Parable of the Sower*. New York: Four Walls Eight Windows.

Dostoevsky, Fyodor. 1864. *Zapiski iz podpolya* (*Notes from Underground*). Serialized in *Epokha*.

Dostoevsky, Fyodor. 1871–72. *Besy* (*Demons*). Serialized in *Russkii vestnik*. Translated by Constance Garnett as *The Possessed*, 1916.

Dostoevsky, Fyodor. 1880. *Brat'ya Karamazovy* (*The Brothers Karamazov*). Serialized in *Russkii vestnik*, 1879–80.

Frank, Pat. 1959. *Alas, Babylon*. Philadelphia: Lippincott.

Goethe, Johann Wolfgang von. 1832. *Faust: Der Tragödie zweiter Teil*. Stuttgart: Cotta.

Hoban, Russell. 1980. *Riddley Walker*. London: Jonathan Cape.

Homer. *Odyssey*.

Ibuse Masuji. 1966. *Kuroi ame*. Tokyo: Shinchōsha. Serialized 1965–66.

Keller, Helen. 1903. *The Story of My Life*. New York: Doubleday, Page.

Kubrick, Stanley, dir. 1964. *Dr. Strangelove, or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Bomb*. Columbia Pictures.

Kubrick, Stanley, dir. 1968. *2001: A Space Odyssey*. Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer.

Le Guin, Ursula K. 1971. *The Lathe of Heaven*. New York: Scribner.

Lem, Stanisław. 1961. *Solaris*. Warsaw: Wydawnictwo MON.

Mandel, Emily St. John. 2014. *Station Eleven*. New York: Knopf.

Maugham, W. Somerset. 1915. *Of Human Bondage*. London: Heinemann.

McCarthy, Cormac. 2006. *The Road*. New York: Knopf.

Merril, Judith. 1950. *Shadow on the Hearth*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday.

Miller, Walter M., Jr. 1959. *A Canticle for Leibowitz*. Philadelphia: Lippincott.

Moore, Ward. 1953. "Lot." *The Magazine of Fantasy and Science Fiction*, May.

Robinson, Kim Stanley. 1984b. *The Wild Shore*. New York: Ace.

Robinson, Kim Stanley. 1992. *Red Mars*. London: HarperCollins.

Roshwald, Mordecai. 1959. *Level 7*. London: Heinemann.

Shakespeare, William. 1600. *The Merchant of Venice*. First Quarto. London: Thomas Heyes.

Shakespeare, William. 1623. *Richard III*; *Henry VI, Part 3*; *The Tempest*. In *Mr. William Shakespeares Comedies, Histories, & Tragedies* (First Folio). London.

Shute, Nevil. 1957. *On the Beach*. London: Heinemann.

Stapledon, Olaf. 1935. *Odd John*. London: Methuen.

Stewart, George R. 1949. *Earth Abides*. New York: Random House.

Strugatsky, Arkady, and Boris Strugatsky. 1972. *Piknik na obochine* (*Roadside Picnic*). Serialized in *Avrora* (Leningrad).

Sturgeon, Theodore. 1953. *More Than Human*. New York: Farrar, Straus & Young.

Teasdale, Sara. 1918. "There Will Come Soft Rains." Collected in *Flame and Shadow*. New York: Macmillan, 1920.

van Vogt, A. E. 1940. *Slan*. Serialized in *Astounding Science Fiction*; book edition Sauk City, WI: Arkham House, 1946.

Vonnegut, Kurt. 1963. *Cat's Cradle*. New York: Holt, Rinehart and Winston.

Wagner, Richard. 1843. *Der fliegende Holländer*. First performed Dresden.

West, Nathanael. 1933. *Miss Lonelyhearts*. New York: Liveright.

Whitman, Walt. 1855–92. *Leaves of Grass*.

Wordsworth, William. 1800. "A slumber did my spirit seal." In *Lyrical Ballads*, 2nd ed. London: Longman.

Wyndham, John. 1955. *The Chrysalids*. London: Michael Joseph.

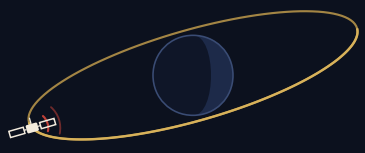
ONLINE RESOURCES CONSULTED FOR PLOT VERIFICATION

Davies, Brian. n.d. "Summary of Philip K. Dick's *Dr. Bloodmoney*." philipkdickfans.com, https://2010philipkdickfans.philipdick.com/articles/davies_bloodmoney.htm. Chapter-by-chapter synopsis used to confirm episode order and chapter references.

"Dr. Bloodmoney, or How We Got Along After the Bomb." n.d. Wikipedia, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dr._Bloodmoney,_or_How_We_Got_Along_After_the_Bomb. Consulted for the working titles and for the statements from Dick's 1980 afterword that it quotes from the Dell edition; those statements have not been checked against the afterword itself.

Keywords

PHILIP K. DICK · *DR. BLOODMONEY* · POST-APOCALYPTIC FICTION · NUCLEAR CRITICISM · COLD WAR CULTURE · ORBITAL ESCHATOLOGY · DIURNAL COMMONS · PHONIC JUSTICE · VENTRILOQUIAL SOVEREIGNTY · METEMPSYCHOTIC SETTLEMENT · WERGILD · COMPENSATION · GIFT ECONOMY · GENERAL ECONOMY · CIGARETTE CURRENCY · RELIQUARY ECONOMY · PARANOIA · SCHREBER · *IDIOS KOSMOS* · *KOINOS KOSMOS* · PROMETHEAN GAP · RESSENTIMENT · THE EXCEPTION · SOVEREIGNTY · PERSONATION · SCAPEGOAT MECHANISM · DISABILITY STUDIES · NARRATIVE PROSTHESIS · THALIDOMIDE · CRYPT AND PHANTOM · CRYPTONYMY · THE DOUBLE · *BARDO THÖDOL* · METEMPSYCHOSIS · NEKYIA · ACOUSMÊTRE · BROADCASTING · SERIALITY · SECONDARY ORALITY · THE STORYTELLER · BRICOLAGE · CYBERNETICS · HOMEOSTASIS · SCHISMOGENESIS · THE PARASITE · DISTRIBUTION OF THE SENSIBLE · SEMIOTIC SQUARE · FREDRIC JAMESON · STARFISH PRIME · TELSTAR · WORDSWORTH · SCIENCE FICTION STUDIES



In earth's diurnal course

SET IN SPECTRAL, DM SERIF DISPLAY AND SPACE MONO · 7 × 10 IN